

SCENE MAP - DEEPER DIVES

How I **Wrote** a book at 6 **AND PROOFREAD IT AT 8**

SCENE MAP

Surface / Deeper Reading / Counting Lens

What this document is

This document brings together, as fully as can currently be articulated, the underlying number score of the piece: the structural, numerical and pattern-based logic running beneath the live event. Some of these patterns may be legible to attentive viewers in the room, especially those who count; others may emerge only for repeat viewers, or through conversation after the fact. This is not a definitive key, but a map of discoveries – a record of patterns that seem to be active in the work.

What this document isn't

This is not a code to be solved, nor a claim that the audience is expected to unlock the piece in full. The system is not there as a puzzle with one correct answer. It is there to be recognised unevenly: glimpsed, noticed, tested, shared, discussed. Different viewers will catch different things, and that partiality is part of the design.

Why this document exists

This document is intended for collaborators rather than audiences. It exists to articulate the deeper structural grammar of the project, while leaving room for future spectators to make discoveries of their own. In that spirit, I imagine the public life of the work eventually including a space where people can share what they counted, what patterns they noticed, and what meanings those patterns opened up for them, without the internal architecture needing to be published whole.

“Just something I noticed” website forum

The Scene Map itself is not intended for publication. What may become public, in longer-term development, is not the map but the act of mapping: a moderated “Just something I noticed” space where audiences can place counts, echoes, structural hunches and partial discoveries alongside what others noticed. The architecture would then become shareable without being handed over whole, allowing the piece to be discovered partially, collectively and over time, rather than reduced to a single authorised reading.

Core number forms

The numbers in this document are not only quantities or letter-counts. I also understand some of them as drawn forms, each carrying a particular kind of movement or relation.

6

6 is an intimate number: a small enclosed loop from which a line extends outward. It begins by holding something close, then reaches beyond itself.

7

7 is a hinge number: one long line that is suddenly interrupted and sent in another direction.

8

8 is an infinite number: two loops joined into one continuous figure. It can be traced forever without leaving the shape.

11

11 is two ones placed beside one another. A single 1 is not prime, but together the two ones form 11, which is. In the project, 11 can therefore hold a particular idea of relation: two distinct bodies do not disappear into one another, but together create something indivisible.

These are not intended as fixed or universal meanings. They are visual intuitions that have emerged through making the work, and which help articulate its underlying movement: **6 holds and reaches, 7 interrupts and redirects, 8 continues without escape, and 11 places two distinct bodies into relation.**

Primality, completion and inversion

Mathematical properties also acquire dramaturgical meaning within the project.

A **prime number** cannot be divided into smaller whole-number factors other than 1 and itself. Primality does not signify superiority or purity here. It marks something that resists decomposition: an irreducible point of contact, presence or relation. This is why the prime-marked scenes function as “contact islands”. Composite numbers, by contrast, contain multiple possible arrangements within themselves. They can be divided, paired and reorganised, making them especially suited to structures of repetition, classification and completion.

12 is a recurrent completion number in Western cultural and numerological traditions: twelve months, twelve signs of the zodiac, twelve hours on the clock face. It is also highly divisible, with the factors 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 and 12. Within the project, 12 becomes the last stable configuration of the old logic: complete, orderly and capable of being divided cleanly into recognised parts.

21 reverses 12 visually while gathering the play’s central sequence arithmetically:

$$6 + 7 + 8 = 21$$

It is also 3×7 , a Fibonacci number, and the sum of the first six positive integers:

$$1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 6 = 21$$

It therefore contains several forms of accumulation at once: three sevens, the complete ascent towards six, and the combined presence of 6, 7 and 8. The date **21 March**, traditionally treated as the first day of spring, also places 21 inside the play’s *Almost Spring* logic: the point at which spring is supposed to arrive. Further recurrences of 21 emerge later in the map.

72 is a densely composite number. It is 6×12 and has exactly **12 positive factors**, arranged into six factor-pairs. Its internal structure admits both 6 and 8, while 7 remains absent as a factor. At the same time, 72 is held directly between the twin primes **71 and 73**. It can therefore be understood as a completed, highly divisible system enclosed on either side by indivisibility: a composite number trapped between two primes.

Key

- On the surface – what a non-primed audience member can reasonably take in (what they see/hear/feel).
- Deeper reading – what the moment can mean structurally/emotionally when patterns accumulate.
- Counting lens – what opens up if the audience is primed to count (title foregrounds 6 and 8, and 7 feels “missing”).
- Prime-marked scenes (·) function as “contact islands” – moments where Maksio is present/closest, or where contact is re-established indirectly (mirroring/harmony/patient presence).

PRE-SHOW – THE ROOM BEGINS

On the surface

- The space opens early; audience settle in.
- Programme available (£6.78) with bio and essays; translations suggested for reading after.
- Everyone receives an A4 handout: scene list, “vocabulary of particularly important terminology”, sensory notes/warnings; earplugs available; audience layout adjusted; no theatre bells to begin the event.

Deeper reading

- “Admin” is dramaturgy: the piece starts by modelling consent, orientation and clarity.
- Programme/handout function as anchors (objects you can hold while meaning destabilises).
- Sensory info is both access and aesthetics: the work names its spikes and gives tools.
- “Read translations after” establishes a temporal ethics: feel first, decode later.

Counting lens

- The show teaches “measurement” before the story begins, so later anomalies read as content, not decoration.
- £6.78 → $6+7+8 = 21$, and the room opens 21 minutes before the show (not 20).

- $21 = 7 \times 3 - 7$ becomes something that multiplies (present as structure) rather than appearing cleanly.

HANDOUT AS INVITATION ARCHITECTURE

1. Front page logic and counting invitations

The front page teaches counting

- The handout teaches counting before the performance begins: “MAKSIO HAS 6 LETTERS. / SISYPHUS HAS ∞ LETTERS. / ERASURE? ABSENCE?” This is not only poetic typography, but a counting tutorial.
- “ERASURE? ABSENCE?” is a riddle whose answer is encoded in the question itself: both words have 7 letters. The missing 7 announces itself through its own definition.
- There are also 6 “ ∞ ” symbols on the front page: 6 eights, 6 infinities, or 6 performances of Masking M across the piece, for which he receives 6 medals.
- The title is 12 words long, while “How I WrotE a book at 6” is 7 words. The clause containing 6 already contains 7, while the clause containing 8 tips the word count to 12. Sisyphus, with his 8 letters and Scene 8 position, is already foreshadowed by the word count.
- “An autistic mathematical tragedy of words” is 6 words and opens the 6-letter world of the piece. “A lifetime of masking” is 4 words. The two riddle lines plus “ERASURE? ABSENCE?” make 14 words in total: 2×7 , and a quiet reference forward to Scene 14, where 6–7–8 returns.

The F-V-N-F-A-C-T board: counting disguised as ornament

- The F-V-N-F-A-C-T board also contains 14 words, if F-V-N-F-A-C-T is counted as one word. F-V-N-F-A-C-T itself is 7 letters. Presented as caps-lock school-board trivia about Żelazowa Wola, the ghost 7 arrives disguised as educational ornament. Certain words appear in capitals precisely to invite letter-counting.
- The board’s frame is drawn like a technical diagram: rounded double borders, corner crosshairs and print-registration marks. But the “fact” inside it is set as a chiselled monumental inscription. Two registers of authority – engineering precision and funerary permanence – are made to occupy the same object before a word of dialogue has been spoken.
- The U→V substitution in F-V-N-F-A-C-T and TREASVRE follows Roman monumental convention, where V stood for both vowel and consonant sounds. Latin, elsewhere in the piece a dead

language of classification – ADNUBES, AMISSUM and FORMICA, all 7 letters – becomes literally lapidary here: not only the language of taxonomy, but the language of gravestones.

- The stone the fact is carved into is not quite a stable plaque. It looks worn, rounded, almost handled: closer to a slab or rock face than a fixed school object. This plants Sisypheus eleven scenes before Scene 12. Something defined by not staying in place is being asked to hold a “fact” presented as settled and permanent.
- The frame is pencil-drawn and provisional, while its contents claim the permanence of carved stone. The red pen’s logic is rehearsed here in miniature: correction, inscription and permanence all placed inside a joke about a composer’s birthplace.
- The corner crosshairs borrow from print production, where separate layers are checked for alignment. Around a bilingual pun and a translated title – “Iron will. Iron freedom.” – they become an alignment-check for the piece’s recurring questions:
 - does Polish align with English?
 - does Maksio align with Masking M?
 - does the six-letter self correspond with the eight-letter one?
- The FUNFACT board is not illustrating the piece’s themes. It is executing them in miniature: blueprint, monument and handwriting stacked on top of one another, unresolved, before the performance begins.

“Just something I noticed”: deflection as invitation

- “Just something I noticed” is handwritten. It belongs to the register of personal aside and deflection, yet it is boxed by the same straight-edged system as the monument it hedges against. The one gesture that asks not to be examined too closely is formally absorbed into the architecture anyway. Even self-effacement gets systematised the moment it is put on the page.
- The joke also depends on the instability of the word “noticed.” Poland’s national treasure Chopin being born in Żelazowa Wola is a fact. You cannot “notice” it. What has been noticed is the underlying system:
 - CHOPIN has 6 letters
 - NATIONAL TREASVRE is 8+8
 - ŻELAZOWA WOLA is 8+4
 - NOTICED has 7 letters
- “Just something I noticed” is therefore one of the handout’s miniature entry points into the piece. Some audience members will notice patterns that others may dismiss as irrelevant. “Just a

fun fact” becomes a familiar style of communication: a way of presenting a pattern lightly because the pattern may be too intense, too private or too much to explain directly.

The first page as a counted field

- The first page contains exactly 11 seven-letter words:
- tragedy / masking / letters / letters / erasure / absence / F-V-N-F-A-C-T / Poland’s / noticed / freedom / Bokhari
- In Scene 11, the figures can be read as both 7s and 1s at the same time.
- The first page also contains exactly 6 eight-letter words:
- autistic / lifetime / Sisyphus / National / Treasure / Żelazowa
- This creates a small 6×8 constellation of identity, duration, labour, value and origin.

2. Scene list as second score

The list teaches structural reading

- The scene list isn’t just navigation – it’s a second score. Its most important function is to teach the reader that the scene titles themselves follow a visible letter-count pattern.
- Pre-primed to count by the rest of the handout, some readers may begin to count the scene titles and notice that the list has been built as a structured field rather than assembled as a series of independent labels.
- Hyphenated titles are an access tool that doubles as a counting trap. Spacing turns Polish / Latin / English into legible units even without Polish fluency, and makes counting letters, beats and units possible as an opt-in layer – a cipher key hidden in plain sight.
- The numbering and typography quietly teach the audience how to read structurally before the play asks them to read emotionally.
- In the revised handout, this teaching function is strengthened through typography. The scene titles, and the front-page counting prompts “MAKSIO HAS 6 LETTERS.” / “SISYPHUS HAS ∞ LETTERS.” / “ERASURE? ABSENCE?”, are set in a monospaced font. Because each character occupies the same visual unit, the page no longer merely permits counting; it points at countability. The handout begins to resemble an exercise sheet in which language has already been discretised into measurable parts.
- This monospaced layer sits slightly awkwardly against the more literary type used elsewhere, and that friction is useful. It makes the counting register feel like a separate system pressing through the page rather than a neutral stylistic choice.

Act 1: single titles and external pairings

- In Act 1, the primary scene names remain single lexical units.
- The Polish Maksio titles are consistently 6 letters long:
 - CHMURY / WIOSNA / MRÓWKA / WOŁACZ
- The Masking M titles before the fulcrum are consistently 8 letters long:
 - CROWDING / TAXONOMY / EMOTIONS
- **CROWDING** is manually tightened so that the letters sit closer together while the monospaced units themselves remain unchanged. The word still contains 8 letters, but is made to occupy roughly the width of a 7-letter title. This keeps the counting system legible while making the title perform its own meaning typographically. It also gives Scene 2 a precise numerical pressure: the first Masking M title lets an 8-letter word force itself into seven's place, prefiguring the scene's wider logic in which 7 does not arrive cleanly but is overtaken, displaced or misdeclared by 8.
- Pairing exists, but is generally supplied from outside the primary title. The Maksio titles are accompanied by seven-letter Latin overlays – ADNUBES, AMISSUM and FORMICA – while WOŁACZ is placed beside the eight-letter English label VOCATIVE.
- The two terms approach the same scene through separate linguistic systems. One names the lived thing, while the other translates, classifies or reframes it.

Act 2: doubleness enters the title

- After the Wołacz fulcrum, pairing moves inside the scene titles themselves.
- Scenes 8–12 are each named through two lexical units whose combined letter count is twice one of the play's central numbers:
 - CLIMBING & SLIPPING = $8+8 = 2\times 8$
 - BELL ANOMAALY = $4+8 = 12 = 2\times 6$
 - INFINITE SYMPHONY = $8+8 = 2\times 8$
 - BURNOUT & HARMONY = $7+7 = 2\times 7$
 - SISYPHUS TRAP = $8+4 = 12 = 2\times 6$
- The Act 2 titles therefore produce the doubled forms of 6, 7 and 8:
 - $12 = 2\times 6$
 - $14 = 2\times 7$
 - $16 = 2\times 8$
- Duality is no longer placed outside the title as translation or classification. It has entered the title's internal construction.

- The equal pairings of 8+8 and 7+7 coexist with complementary 4+8 structures. Two units do not have to be identical in order to produce the required doubled total.
- The ampersand makes the relationship visibly explicit in CLIMBING & SLIPPING and BURNOUT & HARMONY. It is not counted as a letter or word, but operates as a relational hinge: ascent held beside descent, and injury held beside repair. The remaining titles perform their pairing through adjacency alone.

From doubled titles to bodies in harmony to numbers

- After the Wołacz fulcrum, Scenes 8–12 use doubled titles. Two lexical units are held beside one another, but the bodily form of that doubleness keeps changing. It does not correspond straightforwardly to the presence of the Still Figure.
- Scene 8 retains one visible body while its title divides action into CLIMBING & SLIPPING. In Scenes 9–11, the Still Figure enters and a possible relation gradually develops through witnessing, touch, proximity and vocal harmony, but it remains partial, fragile or vulnerable to interruption.
- Scene 12 complicates the pattern again. At Masking M's peak performance, the Still Figure is absent. The audience becomes the scene's collective second body: Masking M performs towards them, bows and receives applause. This creates a relationship, but one organised through evaluation rather than mutuality. Live audience response is swallowed by recorded applause, so recognition becomes coercive machinery and the performer becomes trapped inside the success he has produced.
- The collapse that follows leads into MANTRA. The return to one six-letter title does not restore the earlier single-unit world. Its difference is relational. Scene 13 is the first moment when two bodies reach sustained mirroring, synchronisation and embodied harmony. Scene 11 allowed their voices to build a genuine but fragile relation; here, harmony enters the bodies themselves. They rock together, rise together and carry one shared rhythmic form without becoming identical.
- The title can therefore contract from two words to one not because doubleness has disappeared, but because relation no longer needs to be represented through two adjacent lexical units. One word is now carried by two distinct bodies moving in harmony.
- Scene 14 completes the movement by abandoning ordinary verbal naming altogether. 6–7–8 is not a phrase but a displayed numerical sequence. The private arithmetic that has organised the play becomes the title itself.
- The post-Wołacz title architecture therefore passes through three broad stages:

- two words forming one title while different forms of relation are tested, interrupted or distorted
- one word carried by two bodies in sustained harmony
- no words, only the numerical relation
- What begins as doubleness inside language becomes a series of relational experiments between performer, second performer and audience. Applause offers a false completion through judgement; embodied harmony offers a reciprocal form that can finally be sustained; numbers then expose the architecture underneath both.

The manufactured middle and the Wołacz fulcrum

- The missing 7 is staged on the page. The list jumps from $6+1=8-1$ to 8: the “middle” doesn’t appear cleanly – it has to be manufactured, mirroring how the play treats erasure as something you can feel without being able to name.
- $6+1=8-1$ is dramaturgy, not maths trivia. It makes the Wołacz scene a bridge between 6 and 8 – a constructed seven – so the moment of calling sits precisely where “calling” should happen and then cannot complete.
- Inverted 1·1 foreshadows later mirror logic. The handout pre-loads inversion as a reading rule: reversal, re-framing and the piece’s later folds are already present in the typography. A red question mark next to the inverted number additionally makes uncertainty part of the visual grammar.
- In the scene-list design, the second half after the double line is inverted, consolidating the framing of gaze reversal.

Prime marks and contact islands

- Prime-marked scenes (·), with an intentional mathematical error, act as “contact islands”. They flag moments where Maksio is closest to himself or closest to address, or where contact is re-established indirectly through mirroring, harmony or patient presence – a rhythm of connection inside the larger masking machine.
- Scene 1 retains a black dot even though 1 is not prime. The red pen lightly contests it rather than erasing it cleanly. Scene 2 is genuinely prime, but its dot appears only in red. Its primehood is mathematically correct, yet acknowledged through the wrong system.
- There are 6 scenes in the prime-marked rhythm both before and after correction by the red pen, reflecting the number of letters in MAKSIÖ. Before correction, Scene 1 is wrongly included and

Scene 2 omitted; after correction, the six actual prime-numbered scenes are 2, 3, 5, “7”, 11 and 13.

- The count arrives at the same total through compromised logic: one mark is mathematically wrong but structurally useful, while another is mathematically right but acknowledged only through the red corrective layer.
- The gradual greyscale filling used for the odd-numbered scenes suggests a loose mirror field around the fulcrum. The Still Figure is always present in the scenes that mirror Maksio scenes, but also appears once outside that system – in Scene 10. Their presence almost follows a pattern.

Translation, classification and biographical leakage

- The three Latin overlays – ADNUBES / AMISSUM / FORMICA – are all 7 letters long. They do more than make the Polish legible.
- Latin appears in the piece only as a dead language of classification: taxonomy, formal labels, diagnosis and criteria. It has no relational function anywhere else in the play.
- AD NUBES also literally means “to the clouds”, so it introduces direction and movement as well as naming. The overlays therefore belong to the same logic as the institutional headings in red: life gradually being overlaid by systems that sort and define it from outside.
- Some audience members might notice the connection between the author’s surname, MARZEC – March – and WIOSNA, which appears twice in the scene titles.
- The Prologue is called Prawie Wiosna = Almost Spring, and later Wiosna goes missing. The writer’s surname, the third month of the year associated with early spring, leaves him suspended in the state of “almost”.
- In the current centred layout, **ALMOST SPRING** is allowed to overrun the right edge of the scene-list field, so that the final **G** drops beyond the boundary and the reader sees **SPRIN**. This is a deliberate act of “wrong editing” inside an otherwise careful and institutional-looking page.
- The truncation turns a visible 6+6 structure into 6+5 with one absent letter. Because **G** is the seventh letter of the alphabet, the crop produces a ghost-7 through omission. The reader is made to complete the title mentally, so the handout quietly recruits them into the act of restoration: they must return a single missing letter that is simultaneously the sixth letter of **SPRING** and the seventh letter of the alphabet.
- This also creates an inverted mirror of **BLACK FIGURE**: **ALMOST SPRIN** = 6+5, while **BLACK FIGURE** = 5+6. The Prologue title is therefore shadowed by the second body’s count-pattern, as though the missing final letter has slipped into the play’s two-bodied logic.

The red layer and the loop

- The red pen does not simply “correct mistakes”. It creates a second visual system on top of the first one.
- In the scene list, black marks belong to the underlying counting logic; red marks belong to correction, dispute, intrusion and late acknowledgement.
- Sometimes the red layer contests what is already there, sometimes it adds what was missing, and sometimes it introduces uncertainty without resolving it.
- The handwritten red overlays and the sensory guidance now share the same script-like font, making them read as one continuous secondary hand. The same visual register can therefore warn, clarify, notice, contest or intrude. The red layer becomes less a set of isolated corrections than a parallel authorship moving across the official document.
- The barely legible lines above, referring to the Epilogue, and below, referring to the Prologue, signal the looping nature and look like traces of the previous loop.

Local counts, glitches and anomalies

- There are a total of 8 seven-letter words on the scene list:
- follows / pattern / ad-nubes / amissum / formica / density / burnout / harmony
- ANOMAALY, with the deliberate misspelling intact, contains 8 letters and performs its own definition. The glitch is embedded in the reference material itself, teaching that weirdness has a numerical signature.
- Scene 9 is the only odd-numbered scene not absorbed into the prime-marked contact-island system. Scene 1 is also mathematically non-prime, but is deliberately marked and later given a relational justification.

3. Sensory notes and handwritten guidance

- The sensory information printed in the same handwritten font as “Iron will. Iron freedom.” reads like helpful notes by someone who is helping the audience decipher the handout.
- The wording matters. The notes use the piece’s own pattern-language – almost, mostly, collapse – while still functioning as genuine sensory information.
- Scenes 9, 10 and 12 are the main warning points: three waves of pressure after the Wołacz hinge, with calmer intervals between them. They are also all non-prime scenes in the second half.

- The sensory notes work as both access and aesthetics. They prepare the audience practically, but they also teach the rule-world of the handout.
- Current phrases:
 - Bell bell bell. ALMOST always 3.
 - Frequent blackout. MOSTLY follows a pattern.
 - Patterns collapse.
 - High density. Earplugs?
 - Loud applause.
- The sensory information is written exclusively using 1-, 4-, 6-, 7- and 8-letter words, so that even the access language belongs to the counted world of the piece.

4. Vocabulary as counting system

The columns and their counted structure

- The “Vocabulary of Particularly Important Terminology” is organised into columns by letter count – 4 / 6 / 7 / 8 – turning a reference guide into a counting primer and an almost-official language system that starts to wobble when read closely.
- The vocabulary list functions as a “poem of form”: words cluster according to the play’s letter-count cosmology rather than semantic category.
- The full columns are:
 - 4-cluster: BOOK / MAMO / LOOK / STEP / FOOT / DESK / BELL / BODY / WOLA / MAKS
 - 6-cluster: MARZEC / PRAWIE / WIOSNA / AUTYZM / KSIĘGA / ZOBACZ / WOŁACZ / LUBLIN / CHOPIN / POLSKA
 - 7-cluster: SILENCE / ABSENCE / HEALING / HARMONY / PIANINO / ERASURE / CHANDRA / FORMICA / AMISSUM / KSIĄŻKA
 - 8-cluster: CZERWONY / AUTISTIC / SPECTRUM / DISORDER / TREASURE / TAXONOMY / APPLAUSE / CLIMBING / ANOMALY / DŁUGOPIS / SLIPPING / INFINITY
- The columns contain 10, 10, 10 and 12 words respectively, producing exactly 42 words in total:

$$10 + 10 + 10 + 12 = 42$$

- Forty-two is also 6×7 or 2×21 . It is the sixth integer squeezed between two primes, while 72 – the silence count in the Epilogue – is the eighth such integer.

The heading as entablature: 43 weighing on 42

- The visual design turns the four lexical columns into architectural supports. Four equal, stripped-back Tuscan or Doric capitals sit above the word-clusters, while the words themselves function as implied shafts. Above them, the heading occupies the inscribed face of an entablature – the horizontal architectural field where an official dedication or declaration might ordinarily appear. The vocabulary therefore presents itself as a miniature monument to classification.
- Printed as VOCABULRY OF PARTICULARLY IMPORTANT TERMINOLOGY, the heading contains 43 letters. The correctly spelt version would contain 44. Forty-three therefore weighs directly above the 42-word field, turning the upper prime bordering 42 into a literal horizontal load.
- This extends the handout's existing border logic. Forty-two is held between the twin primes 41 and 43, while 72 is held between 71 and 73. The heading makes 43 visible as the upper border of the vocabulary field, while the programme's 73-kilometre border-distance fact makes the corresponding upper border of 72 biographical and geographical.
- The missing A in VOCABULRY is not simply erased. It reappears inside ANOMAALY. The one-letter subtraction from the heading and the one-letter addition inside the 8-letter column balance exactly: the anomaly has not disappeared from the system but migrated from its title into its classified contents.
- The misspelling also briefly recruits the reader into the red-pen position. Spotting a linguist's apparent error may produce a small flash of corrective satisfaction. Encountering ANOMAALY then reverses that relationship: the reader discovers that the missing letter has been deliberately stored elsewhere. The page first rewards correction, then catches the correcting gaze inside its structure.
- The equal capitals strengthen this tension. The architecture insists that the four classifications possess the same formal status, even though the material suspended beneath them is not equally weighted or equally stable.

The four-letter column as a field of small systems

- The 4-letter column is organised around short, apparently elementary words that reveal themselves, on inspection, as small systems.

STEP / FOOT / DESK / BELL / BODY

- Each organises an action or relationship. FOOT becomes STEP; BODY is positioned at DESK; BELL controls transition, timing and obedience.
- Four letters therefore begin to function as the glossary's compact system-register: a language through which bodies are moved, placed, cued and observed.

- The remaining words complicate that register rather than sitting outside it. BOOK introduces translation and inscription. MAMO and LOOK introduce calling and gaze. WOLA holds place, will and freedom. MAKŚ makes personal origin visible through spelling.
- The column therefore opens a series of questions. What kinds of system are contained inside BOOK, MAMO, LOOK, WOLA and MAKŚ? Can translation, love, origin and the desire to be seen also organise or correct a body?

BOOK / KSIĘGA / KSIĄŻKA: one object across three systems

- The vocabulary contains three forms of the book across three different columns:
 - BOOK = 4
 - KSIĘGA = 6
 - KSIĄŻKA = 7
- BOOK is not the word Maksio would have used when he wrote the object at six. He did not yet speak English. The apparently simple English noun is therefore already a retrospective translation: the adult, English-language name placed over a Polish childhood act.
- The title's "book" is not neutral. It makes the original object portable and immediately legible to an English-speaking audience, but it also places that object inside a later linguistic system. The act of saying BOOK is itself part of the translation architecture.
- KSIĘGA belongs to the six-letter column and therefore shares the count of MAKŚIO. It is not the ordinary everyday word for a child's book, but a grander, weightier or more monumental form: a tome, volume, ledger or "great book". Inside the six-letter world, the child's creation acquires the scale and seriousness it had for him.
- KSIĄŻKA, the ordinary Polish word for a book, contains 7 letters. It occupies the same column as SILENCE, ABSENCE, ERASURE, HEALING and HARMONY. The everyday object therefore enters the unstable seven-world, where loss and correction coexist with the possibility of relation and repair.
- No equivalent of the book appears in the 8-letter column. Instead, that column contains CZERWONY and DŁUGOPIS: the two words naming the red pen.
- The book is therefore not translated into the eight-letter world. It is acted upon by it. The object written at six disappears from the vocabulary at eight, while the instrument of correction survives as an 8+8 structure.

MAX / MAKŚ / MAKŚIO: spelling origin into visibility

- MAKŚ also complicates the four-letter system. In most professional English-language contexts, the writer uses MAX, a three-letter spelling that travels easily and does not strongly announce where it comes from.
- For the theatre project, MAX becomes MAKŚ. The spoken name remains nearly the same, but its written form becomes more visibly Polish. One additional character is enough to move the name from English-passing familiarity towards a small confession of origin.
- The transformation is not merely the addition of a letter. English X compresses the sounds /k/ and /s/ into one written character, while Polish KS writes those components separately. The same name is therefore processed as one written unit in MAX and two written units in MAKŚ.
- This reverses and complements the problem of ch in *Wołacz*. There, two written characters are required to function as one sound. Here, one English character is opened into two Polish characters. In both cases, identity changes according to what a language considers to be a single written unit.
- The name sequence can therefore be read as:
 - MAX = 3
 - MAKŚ = 4
 - MAKŚIO = 6
- As the name lengthens, it becomes less English-passing and more biographically specific: professional portability gives way first to visible Polish origin, and then to the intimate childhood form.
- So MAKŚ is not simply a neutral midpoint between MAX and MAKŚIO. It is a deliberate theatrical spelling: still recognisable to an English-speaking audience, but no longer allowing origin to pass completely unnoticed.

MAMO, LOOK and correction through love

- MAMO and LOOK sit together in the four-letter column. Read beside one another, they anticipate the play's central call: "Mamo, look at me."
- MAMO is itself a grammatical form produced by the system of calling: the Polish vocative of mama. It belongs both to intimate relationship and to the formal grammar explored in *Wołacz*.
- LOOK introduces the other half of that structure. The call does not only ask for an answer; it asks to be seen. Calling and gaze become linked systems of recognition.
- MAMO may also place parental love inside the play's corrective apparatus. This does not make the parent cruel or reduce care to control. It asks how correction can be transmitted through

love and good intentions: how a parent may teach, reshape or correct a child precisely because they want that child to be safe, successful or understood.

- The four-letter system is not exclusively mechanical or institutional. It can include attachment, protection and care. The same relationship may provide recognition and participate in correction at once.

Autism across six and eight

- AUTISTIC, SPECTRUM and DISORDER are all exactly 8 letters long.
- The 6-letter column contains AUTYZM – spelt the Polish way – creating a distinction between the six-letter Polish form and the eight-letter English vocabulary surrounding diagnosis and classification.
- The first three words in the 6-letter column are MARZEC / PRAWIE / WIOSNA. Read together, they create another lens on the Prologue and Scene 3: the writer's surname, "almost" and the missing Spring appear as a three-word sequence before the performance begins.

Position, recurrence and the sandbox

- The first three columns contain ten words, while the 8-letter column contains twelve. For ten rows, the architecture appears capable of closing cleanly: **MAKS / POLSKA / KSIĄŻKA / DŁUGOPIS** form a shared lower line. But the fourth column then continues beneath that apparent base through **SLIPPING** and **INFINITY**.
- **SLIPPING** is therefore not only a term inside the vocabulary but a positional event on the page. It is the first word to pass below the common ten-row ground established by the other columns. **INFINITY** follows beneath it, extending the imbalance rather than allowing the support to finish.
- Because all four capitals are equal, the excess cannot be explained through a hierarchy announced at the top. The architecture promises four equivalent supports, but one carries additional length and weight. The 8-letter column cannot settle on the same ground as the others unless the ground itself yields.
- A very slight slant in the implied columns makes that instability perceptible without turning it into illustration. The structure remains almost plumb and almost authoritative, but not fully. The technical drawing still claims precision while its supporting language quietly drifts away from the vertical.
- **INFINITY** is the twelfth word in the 8-letter column. This can be read as another reference to Sisyphus, the relationship between 8 and ∞ , and Scene 12. Its position beneath **SLIPPING** also produces a tiny vertical narrative: once the system slips beyond its apparent base, it does not arrive at a new stable ground but continues into infinity.

- The vocabulary is a sandbox rather than a glossary to be “learnt”. Its terms are movable blocks. They can be read in rows, in columns or at random, allowing meanings to emerge through different constellations.
- The meaning of the vocabulary also shifts when it is read after the performance. Words that initially appear to offer orientation may later carry the scenes, bodies, sounds and pressures that have accumulated around them.

5. Crumbs, audience attention, and dramaturgical function

- The play leaves crumbs for pattern-attention – mirrored in MRÓWKA, where Maksio traces ant paths and discovers equivalence: mrówka = 6 letters = 6 legs.
- The counting layer is opt-in. The piece works emotionally and physically without tracking, and rewards active counting with additional coherence.
- The handout provides the cipher key; the performance provides the crumb trail; the programme extends the reading field; and this Scene Map records the fuller internal architecture.
- Overall, the handout models admin-as-dramaturgy. What looks like orientation – scene map, markings and warnings – is also a consent-based invitation into the play’s perceptual mode: you can just watch, or you can start noticing how the system counts you back.

PROGRAMME AS EXTENDED READING FIELD

1. Function and timing

- The programme is not a post-show key. It is available before the event and contains the author bio, three dramaturgical essays, and translations of the Polish scenes.
- Only the translations are explicitly suggested for reading after the performance. The essays are there as a parallel reading field rather than a delayed explanation.
- Like the handout, the programme is designed to be legible without decoding – but it also rewards later pattern-noticing.

2. The bio turns origin into counted information

- The bio gives Lublin not sentimentally but as ranked and measured fact: Poland’s 9th largest city, 73• km from the Ukrainian border.

- This quietly foreshadows Scene 2, where Polish cities appear as population-data under pressure and Lublin is numerically displaced.
- The focus on Chopin's birthplace in the handout primes some audience members to pay particular attention to the author's birthplace in the programme.

3. The essay titles continue the 6–7–8 world

- The three essay titles replay the piece's number cosmology in prose form:
 - W-O-Ł-A-C-Z = 6
 - H-I-R-A-E-T-H = 7
 - N-A-T-I-O-N-A-L T-R-E-A-S-U-R-E = C-Z-E-R-W-O-N-Y D-Ł-U-G-O-P-I-S = 8+8 = 8+8
- 4 is also present in N-O-T-E, mirroring the vocabulary list (4-6-7-8).
- There are also further references in the subtitles: WOŁACZ (6) – the Grammar (7) of Calling (7), HIRAETH (7) – the Mathematics (11) of Almost (6).
- So the programme does not merely discuss the counting system – it starts to behave according to it.

4. Ghost-7 and prime logic leak into the essays

- The programme preserves the notation Scene 6+1=8-1• inside the Wołacz essay, so the manufactured / missing 7 remains active outside the scene list.
- At the end of Hiraeth, the line “7• letters.” briefly marks the ghost-7 directly.
- In the current programme, the interpunct remains sparse rather than decorative: it appears as a quiet prime-marking leak rather than a repeated visual gimmick (73 also marked as prime - a total of three marked primes).

5. The programme extends the rule-world into paratext

- The essays do not solve the piece. They extend its deeper patterning into biography, title-length, numbering, border-distance, and typographic marks.
- The (planned) numbered Poland map belongs to the same logic: geography rendered as ranked points rather than sentimental landscape.
- Overall, the programme functions as an extended reading field: less a decoder than a second document in which the piece's numerical and dramaturgical grammar keeps speaking.

PROLOGUE = FINALE

PRAWIE WIOSNA = ALMOST SPRING

On the surface

- Warm-lit empty room; book visible.
- Desk/chair/jacket/medals appear, then are removed by assistants.
- The red pen rolls off and lands on the floor. Nobody picks it up.
- Wordless movement: breath-notes (Chopin fragment texture), oom-pa-pa pulse, ballet vocabulary.
- Book-handling becomes intimate; a faint 3+3 waltz pulse is triggered when it touches the floor; he contracts into stillness and snaps into Scene 1.

Deeper reading

- “Prologue = Finale” declares a loop-world: return replaces resolution.
- All of the play's props are laid bare before the audience - objects that have not yet been assigned meaning.
- Removing the desk in plain sight: the institution is stripped away but will keep haunting the body.
- Red pen drop is a double-read:
 - Surface: a tiny stage accident / unadjusted prop.
 - Deeper: correction is dislodged at the outset and left uncollected – looming, unresolved presence.
- Breath-notes (not melody) frame expression as nearly-speech / nearly-song.
- There is also a small Chopin-facing 3+1 logic underneath the Prologue material: three closely related phrase-events establishing the pattern, with a fourth arriving as slight turn, thinning or release rather than simple repetition.

- The book becomes self-object / self-evidence, not just prop.
- The floor-touch pulse seeds the work's rule: objects can "score" the body.
- The title of the Prologue can be read as a pun on the author's surname: Marzec - March, the third month, where nature slowly comes to life but it isn't yet in full bloom. (The 6-letter column on the vocabulary grid starts with "MARZEC PRAWIE WIOSNA").

Counting lens

- PROLOGUE (8 letters) followed by FINALE (6 letters) – "you came for 8 (proofreading), but we start by looking at 6 (writing/childhood)".
- The sum of these is 14, the same as MAKSIÓ + MASKING M or WOŁACZ + VOCATIVE.
- This 8-6 relationship can also be read as the adult performer (stuck in a loop of masking) returning to his 6-letter self and moving in a way that Maksio wanted to move.
- According to the Project Pack, the Prologue opens in Mythical Poland (mirroring the letter count of Prologue Finale).
- Prawie (6) Wiosna (6) matches Almost (6) Spring (6) – bilingual equilibrium describing an "almost" state.
- The waltzes follow an 8+4 logic mirroring ŻELAZOWA WOLA letter count.
- The last waltz is 11 notes, which references the BLACK FIGURE being present in the Prologue.
- The total number of Chopin breath notes in the Prologue is 47 - a prime number, which will occur again in the Lublin population count as a slip.

SCENE 1· (not prime but marked) – CHMURY (ADNUBES)

On the surface (English)

- Warm, free movement; fast Polish addressed to "Mamo" (recognisable anchor).
- High energy, laughter, reaching, sudden freezes, "bleh" texture moments.
- "Klauts" (wrong "clouds") is legible as English inside Polish.

- Bells cut the scene mid-flow into harsh school light.

On the surface (Polish)

- A boy talking excitedly to his mum about clouds, fog, taste, words, wonder.
- “Klauts” reads as a nursery-teacher quote repeated because authority said it.

Deeper reading (English)

- The nervous system is visible: joy → freeze → joy (state clipping).
- Bells act as conditioning: warm messy selfhood is overwritten by “school mode”.
- “Klauts” plants a seed of tragedy: mis-taught language carried as truth.
- Book ↔ floor pulse establishes that even play has a metre attached.

Deeper reading (Polish)

- “Mniebo” as a slip of the tongue that merges “me” and “sky” – untranslatable into English.
- The first line is retrospectively almost the same as the final line “Mamo, look at me!”. It will only be caught by Polish viewers and script readers. The spoken text starts with a plea in Polish. By the final line, Mamo remains untranslated (and as argued in the programme – untranslatable), but the rest of the line is in English. The two languages can coexist.
- “Na mniebo” and “Look at me” are both 8 letters long.
- “Urwanie chmury” is a semantic trapdoor (literal vs idiomatic) – language performs mismatch.
- Cloud-as-stone seeds later Sisyphus logic, but here it’s joy and agency.
- He is convinced the world responds to him: he stares at the sky long enough that it “turns” and that he has torn a piece of the cloud off with his hands. The fusion of me and sky is repeated in Maksio’s plea to be taken back to fog. He’s excited because it’s as if the sky descends towards him.
- He momentarily believes he has caused a change in the weather: after “tearing” the cloud with his hands, he warns Mama that there is going to be a “straszne burzysko”. The child’s logic is not symbolic from his point of view but immediate and real – the environment responds to him, and he responds back with excitement, alarm and performative care.

- This also deepens the connection to Scene 4 (Taxonomy): weather begins here not as classification but as intimate, reactive event. Before clouds are sorted into categories, they are something he can touch, tear, taste, fear, and warn someone about.
- He makes a logic jump when he suddenly says “Probably like candyfloss?”
- Fog-as-cloud reframes taxonomy as intimacy: a desire to be inside the thing that obscures.
- The line where he asks Mama to take him back into fog because back then he didn't know it was a cloud is a reference to rewriting your life experience post-diagnosis: retrospectively analysing what you already experienced without the correct framework.
- Unashamed hunger for knowledge, logic jumps, “playful” synaesthesia.
- In summary, this scene is the ultimate contact island: it's a sensory feast for Maksio: multisensory references, height, and agency are all woven into the script of Scene 1.

Counting lens

- Not actually prime but marked as such in black and corrected by the red pen on the handout.
- Chmury = 6 (child/home-world).
- ADNUBES or AdNubes = 7 – “to the clouds”, introducing prescribed direction as well as Latin categorisation.
- Maks Marzec is 4+6, reflected in “mamo, zobacz!” – 4+6.
- Maksio is 6 letters.
- Mama (4 letters) corrects Maksio's wrong znikły (6 letters) to the correct zniknęły (8 letters).
- After hearing *urwanie chmury*, Maksio processes it into *rwanie chmury*. RWANIE CHMURY contains 6+6 written letters but 5+5 sound-units, because **ni** and **ch** each function as one sound. The playful reinterpretation therefore moves the phrase into Maksio's six-letter world before STRASZNE BURZYSKO expands it into 8+8 letters and 7+7 sounds.
- “Straszne burzysko” is 8+8. In the English translation, “hell-of-a-storm” is 12 letters. In a scene otherwise rooted in 6-world wonder, Maksio briefly enters a larger performative register, foreshadowing his future performance in the 8-world – a movement that eventually culminates in Scene 12 (Sisyphus Trap).

- 7 reads as erasure: trying to codify the lived thing is itself a reduction (echo: assessment criteria).
- Prime marking tags this as a key “Maksio contact” node.

SCENE 2• (prime) – CROWDING

On the surface

- Harsh classroom light: Masking M sits rigidly and recites a list of cities by population.
- He slips, corrects, saves himself – then footsteps arrive; he rips a page to stop them.

Deeper reading

- He follows 6 with 8 – can read like a mistake, but then he stretches 6-letter “Lublin” into 8-letter “L-l-lublin”, which again reads like a slip.
- Birthplaces carry meaning, not just in the piece, but as markers of identity in societies. Both Lublin and Żelazowa Wola (Chopin’s birthplace) are used as dramaturgical motifs.
- On Lublin: the correction lands like a quiet bomb – “forty-eight... forty-seven.” Later, the bio reveals he’s from Lublin, so the glitch becomes autobiography. The correction is a small subtraction, but it also reveals the only 7 that appears anywhere in the population figures.
- The figures are very 8-heavy, priming the ear for 8.
- All the population numbers are divisible by 8, reinforcing the sense that the list belongs to a system of measurement rather than to lived geography.
- None of the population numbers contain the digit 7. The only 7 appears in the spoken correction, leaking into the system through a moment of instability. Some listeners may feel the absence even if they cannot name it.
- Lublin is moved up the ranking (it should be 9th, instead moved to 7th but declared as 8), reflecting ambition to be “higher” even when wrong. Since only the top 8 cities are included, Lublin wouldn’t have made it.

- Precision is both protection and absurd: fixing the living world into digits raises the question of who gets counted.
- Footsteps arriving after the fact teach delayed consequence.
- The rip becomes behavioural conditioning: self-erasure stops the approach.

Counting lens

- Scene 2 is actually prime but only marked as such by the red pen.
- Crowding = 8 letters – 8-world stamp: performance/measurement/loop.
- The first word spoken by MASKING M in the piece (after “1”) is Warszawa - 8 letters, 7 sounds, 6 letters in English (Warsaw), and 4 sounds – the whole vocabulary grid in one word.
- Populations of 8 cities are recited.
- Masking M = $7+1 = 8$ letters.
- Sisyphus = 8 letters.
- 8-8 appears as a loop inside the list.
- All population figures are multiples of 8, and in the updated sequence their pre-slip total is divisible by 512 (8^3) – the list quietly locks into the logic of the system it performs. This matters because the slip operates on three simultaneous layers, and that threefold structure is itself mirrored by the cubic form of 8^3 .
- The only 7 appears in the slip: in 47, a prime number.
- After the slip, Lublin’s population becomes 361,447, which is also prime. In symbolic terms, the correction removes one from the count and leaves behind a number that can no longer be divided. When he leaves, Lublin changes for him.
- The same transformation occurs at the level of the whole list: before the slip, the total population of the 8 cities is divisible by 512; after the slip on Lublin, it becomes 5,973,503, which is prime.
- Additionally, from 5,973,503 the distance to the nearest prime is only 6 up or down. In both directions, the total sum after the slip is only MAKSIÓ letters away from its nearest prime.

- So 48 becoming 47 creates a threefold mathematical hinge: the spoken number, Lublin's population, and the total population across the 8 cities all shift from an 8-based structure into indivisibility.
- 48 (6x8) features quite prominently across the list: 4 cities end on 48, with Lublin corrected to 47. This is a callback to the PROLOGUE breath motifs. It's also a recurrence of the 3+1 architecture, with the end inverted.
- The fact that Lublin has been moved up the list isn't hidden - Lublin's recited population is clearly lower than Szczecin's.
- MASKING M says Wrocław slightly higher - slightly more Maksio-like - it's the only 7-letter city name on the list.
- Otherwise, the cities are either 4 / 6 or 8 letters long: Łódź / Kraków, Gdańsk, Poznań, (Lublin) / Warszawa, Szczecin, (L-l-lublin), reflexively. The 8-letter cities (the first and last on the list), are 7 and 6 sounds.
- The container of the 8-letter title (CROWDING) either contains the first and last words or not, depending on interpretation (letters vs sounds).

SCENE 3· (prime) – WIOSNA (AMISSUM)

On the surface (English)

- Warm light; frantic searching; repeated "Mamo"; escalating distress; stomping.
- "Don't make me go further" energy reads clearly in the body.
- Bells interrupt mid-breath and slam into desk-world.

On the surface (Polish)

- He has lost "Spring" and treats it like a missing being; he refuses to proceed until it's found.
- The spiral lands in guilt: "it's because of me".

Deeper reading (English)

- Loss → search → refusal to progress → collapse, legible in structure.
- Bell pattern becomes crueler: the system interrupts distress rather than waiting for calm.
- Institutional geometry intrudes: childhood distress happens inside “bench/school space”.

Deeper reading (Polish)

- “Wiosna” carries more than an object: loss of softness/permission/growth/promise.
- Guilt reflex prefigures Masking M: responsibility assumed before evidence.
- The author's surname is Marzec (March), the Prologue = Finale is entitled Almost Spring, which starts on 21st March - Maksio was promised his spring but it never arrived.
- The phrase “zgubiła się przeze mnie” carries certain lexical tension: the reflexive pronoun “się” suggests things happening naturally or without external input, “she lost herself”, yet Maksio blames himself.

Counting lens

- Wiosna = 6; Amissum = 7 – lived 6 overlaid with 7-letter Latin loss-frame (“official” disappearance).
- Prime mark = another direct “Maksio” island.

SCENE 4 – TAXONOMY

On the surface

- Masking M recites cloud definitions in a flat exam voice.
- A warning structure creeps into the neutral descriptions. The sequence moves from high and very high clouds down through mid-level and low-level layers. Footsteps approach; the rip stops them.

- After the blackout, a single clap is heard from just behind the outer edge of the front rows. From the same place, an adult female voice, overenthusiastic and apparently trying to be discreet, says: “Good job, M!”

Deeper reading

- Curiosity becomes compliance: taxonomy as self-surveillance.
- The cloud sequence has its own downward trajectory. It begins at high altitude, rises briefly to “very high”, then drops through mid-level and low-to-mid layers until it settles among low clouds. After one small upward movement, the sky is progressively brought down, flattened and layered over the body.
- This reverses the movement of Scene 1 and its Latin overlay, *Ad Nubes* – “to the clouds”. Maksio’s attention moves upwards; he wants to enter the sky, touch it and understand it from inside. Fog is exciting because a cloud has descended far enough for him to inhabit it. In *Taxonomy*, descent no longer produces intimacy. Clouds become sheets and layers that cover the entire sky, obscure the sun and announce approaching rain.
- What seemed marvellous in Scene 1 is retrospectively rewritten as warning. The cloud that could be torn, tasted or entered becomes something that hangs above him, limits visibility and may grow into a storm. Classification does not merely name the child’s wonder; it reorganises that wonder into threat.
- “Particularly spectacular” is delivered flatly: something you’re taught to say rather than feel.
- A pronunciation slip, with the Polish “u” migrating into English on “cumulus”, eventually triggers the footsteps. This is a quiet wink at Scene 1, which ends with Maksio saying “klauts” – this time, the Polish way of saying “cumulus” becomes an English mispronunciation that is censored. The line ends on “clouds” in English.
- Footsteps arriving after “fair weather” teach that safety statements do not create safety.
- The final claim that cumulus clouds hang at exactly eight metres creates the darkest version of the reversal. The cloud is brought almost to ground level, but not as fog that surrounds and meets Maksio. It remains suspended just above him: close enough to dominate the space, too high to reach, dense enough to obscure, and still capable of growing into a storm cloud.
- The first feedback arrives from the threshold between stage and auditorium. On the surface, it may sound like a teacher, parent, supporter or spectator praising a successful recital. Because it

follows the page-rip, however, the praise becomes structurally attached to the act of self-erasure that stopped the footsteps.

- The enthusiasm is slightly too bright for what has just happened. The voice still sounds human and socially plausible, but its warmth is misdirected: the room celebrates the behaviour that has damaged the book.
- The voice comes from among the spectators rather than from the stage machinery. Praise therefore enters first as a social response. The auditorium becomes part of the conditioning apparatus before the audience has been fully taught how to recognise it.

Counting lens

- TAXONOMY = 8 letters – classification as 8-world authority.
- Six cloud types are defined, with the 6-world continuing to seep through.
- Cirrus has 6 letters and is “often the first sign of an approaching warm front”.
- Cumulus is the only cloud type with 7 letters.
- Cumulus is also the sixth and final cloud type, and it is said to hang at exactly 8 metres. The definition therefore compresses 6–7–8 into one line: sixth position, seven-letter name, eight-metre height. The central sequence appears to progress cleanly at precisely the moment when the taxonomy makes its most absurd claim.
- “Exactly 8 metres” reads as absurd precision and as safety sought through measurement. The only seven-letter cloud is fixed inside an imposed 8-world height.
- The sequence of stated heights also behaves like a descent: high → very high → mid-level → low-to-mid → low → low. After one initial rise, taxonomy repeatedly lowers the cloud-world. The final “8 metres” gives that downward movement an exact numerical endpoint.
- None of the cloud types are exactly 8 letters long – the taxonomic container does not fit.
- GOOD JOB contains 7 letters; GOOD JOB M contains 8. “Good job” contains 6 sound-units, while the spoken “em” brings the total to 8. The first feedback therefore moves from 7→8 in letters and from 6→8 in sound.

SCENE 5• (prime) – MRÓWKA (FORMICA)

On the surface (English)

- Warm light returns immediately after “Good job, M!”, but the safe zone is smaller and more distant.
- He crouches, traces ant paths, giggles, and moves through “bleh” moments.
- He spells a word and points to legs; pattern delight reads visually.
- The red pen is now in his hand, completely unacknowledged.
- “Mamo...?” repeats and is cut by bells.

On the surface (Polish)

- Systems-joy: ant motorways, strength, crumbs bigger than the ant.
- Mrówka has as many letters as legs – delight at the discovery.
- Curiosity leaps to capitals and populations.
- The final question asks whether, if an ant gets lost, someone goes back for it.

Deeper reading (English)

- “Good job, M!” is the final sound heard before the warm child-world returns. The praise therefore follows Maksio into the scene rather than remaining safely attached to Masking M and the desk.
- The transition makes the red pen in Maksio’s hand more disturbing. The previous scene has just rewarded a page-rip, and now the instrument of correction has migrated into play, curiosity and pattern-delight.
- Its presence is completely unacknowledged. Maksio does not discover it, question it or react to it; the child-world returns already carrying the tool of correction as though it has always belonged there.
- The red pen in the child-world therefore reads as contamination: correction migrates into play.

- Pattern hunger is legible without semantics through spelling, counting and the delight of equivalence.
- The call is always cut at the moment of address.

Deeper reading (Polish)

- Miniature Sisyphus: pushing a crumb bigger than herself is the myth in micro-form.
- Maksio's discovery – mrówka = letters = legs – no longer makes sense in English; his delight does not translate.
- "Pani Mrówko", a formal vocative, lands humorously but also shows safety in formal address.
- The "lost ant" rhymes with lost Spring: fear of abandonment is expressed through small beings.
- Repeated "Mamo" becomes a test of whether address is met.

Counting lens

- MRÓWKA = 6; FORMICA = 7 – codification-as-erasure returns.
- The prime mark makes this the third "Maksio contact" node.
- "No sorry... sorki, Pani Mrówko" is exactly 21 letters long. It is the only other occurrence of the vocative case in the text - the other one is "Mamo" repeated a total of 21 times. The translated line "Soz... Really sorry, Mrs. Ant" is 20 letters long - one short.

SCENE 6 – EMOTIONS

On the surface

- Masking M delivers dictionary definitions of happiness, empathy, shame, rejection and other emotions.
- Harsh ideological phrases cut through and contaminate the definitions.
- Footsteps approach; he rips out a page; the recitation ends with "Feeling nothing is safety."

- After the blackout, no clap is heard. A voice with the same timbre as the earlier speaker returns from further back in the auditorium, on the opposite side:

"Well done, M!"

- The words remain in the darkness before the weak light of the next scene appears.

Deeper reading

- Language becomes possession: the official definition voice is invaded by internalised authority.
- The scene presents a full curriculum of self-erasure: feelings are weakness or danger; numbness is safety.
- The rip is now practised, turning self-erasure into muscle memory.
- The second feedback follows the most gruelling recital so far: feeling has been converted into definition, ideological rules have invaded the sentences, and the final conclusion is "Feeling nothing is safety." "Well done, M!" can therefore be heard as rewarding fluency, numbness, the clean page-rip and the successful suppression of everything the scene has named.
- The praise has moved further into the auditorium and crossed to the opposite side. What first sounded like one overenthusiastic person near the front begins to spread through the room, suggesting that the approval is not isolated but systemic.
- "Well done, M!" remains in the darkness and is followed by Maksio quietly asking "Mam chandře?" The system congratulates him for feeling nothing; the next scene reveals the low mood left behind, and nobody answers it.
- After Scene 5, some viewers might notice that the top of the desk is made of Formica.

Counting lens

- EMOTIONS = 8 letters – institutionalised feeling as a performance category.
- Six emotions are defined, allowing the 6-world to seep inside the 8-world.
- "Shame has 8 meanings", while EMOTIONS has 8 letters. Shame is colonised by the system: it comes in many shades and becomes the scene's governing emotion.
- Only one meaning of shame is provided, so the other seven remain absent, enacting the 8-1 structure of the next scene.

- None of the emotions has exactly 8 letters. They do not fit neatly inside their taxonomic container, just as the cloud types do not fit inside TAXONOMY in Scene 4.
- EMPATHY is the only emotion with 7 letters, but 6 sounds.
- “Feeling nothing is safety” contains words of 7, 7 and 6 letters.
- WELL DONE contains 8 letters; WELL DONE M contains 9. “Well done” contains 6 sound-units, while the spoken “em” brings the total to 8. Sonically, the feedback repeats the same 6→8 movement as “Good job, M!”, even while its written count advances.

SCENE 6+1 = 8–1• (prime) – WOŁACZ (VOCATIVE)

On the surface (English)

- Dim off-centre light; rocking; no eye contact; long held silence.
- A short Polish line with no reply.
- Patterned ritual: spelling, counting and declension-like repetition, audible without semantics.
- He reaches “Wołacz...” and stops. Blackout. After a brief pause, the same word is heard again from the far-right rear of the auditorium as a distant, disembodied echo:

Wołacz...

- He rolls the red pen towards the audience.

On the surface (Polish)

- “Mam chandrę?” – low mood – is named quietly and met with silence.
- He turns mood into grammar, declining chandra through the cases until “Wołacz...”, where he cannot complete the final form.
- The echo relocates the call to the room.

Deeper reading (English)

- Autistic self-regulation is staged as form through reduced light, rocking, silence and repetition.

- The counting on fingers, whether experienced by a Polish- or non-Polish-speaking audience member, recalls Maksio's earlier joyful counting of the ant's legs in Scene 5.
- In Mrówka, Maksio applies a logic of perfect equivalence: mrówka has as many letters as the ant has legs. The fit gives him immense joy, certainty and a sense that the world has been built with elegance.
- Here, he attempts the same equilibrium with chandra and the case system. He tries to make the word fit its structure as neatly as the ant fitted its count.
- But this time the fit is false. The same pattern-seeking instinct that generated delight in the previous Maksio scene now leads into misalignment and failure.
- The dramatic action is failure-to-finish: the sequence breaks at the end.
- But the failure is not only at the end. It is preloaded from the beginning. Maksio starts from a wrongly counted and wrongly held version of the word and tries to carry it through a seven-case system, so the breakdown at "Wołacz..." is the delayed arrival of an error already built into the ritual.
- The echo does not complete the form. The room gives back only the name of the mechanism – Wołacz – rather than the vocative itself.
- What returns is grammatical classification, not relational repair. The theatre can name what is missing, but it cannot supply the missing address.
- The red pen is "handed over" to the audience while the word returns as an echo: not resolution, only faint mirroring.

Deeper reading (Polish)

- It sounds like primary school: comfort and constraint at once.
- He miscounts the number of letters in a very specifically Polish way. Children learning to spell often struggle with h and ch, which make the same sound and are remnants of the language's phonological past. This may initially register as funny to some Polish-speaking audience members.
- A deeper meaning of this subtraction arrives through the structure of the scene: it is "doomed" in a specifically Polish way.

- Correctness requires recognising that **ch** is one sound represented by two written characters. To reach seven, Maksio must be willing – or conditioned – to count that apparently single sound as two written components, even though one contributes no separately audible unit.
- The difficulty therefore lies in accepting a rule under which one functioning unit must be processed as two components.
- This gives the spelling error a wider structural resonance. In miniature, it contains the play's two-body logic: one functioning identity distributed across two bodies.
- It also encapsulates the tragedy of Masking M and Maksio: two versions of the same body and two languages, but ultimately one fractured person trying to pass as a single functioning unit in a world that does not fit them.
- What he declines is therefore not quite chandra, but his own six-letter version of it: a word that sounds right and partly functions, but is not fully the same word.
- The customary instrumental formula would normally include z before chandrą. Its omission may register to attentive Polish ears as a smaller anticipatory absence. The recitation rehearses non-completion before it arrives at the larger failure of the missing vocative.
- Wołacz is direct address: the form exists, but the call cannot land.
- Grammar is refuge and loneliness. Feeling becomes structure when relational speech fails.
- How do you translate chandra? It is image-laden; everything in English becomes an “almost”.
- The English scenes until now contain definitions, and definitions are in the nominative.
- Here, the scene knows perfectly well what the vocative is but cannot use it. The category survives; the act does not.
- The Polish word odmiana names grammatical inflection or declension, as in odmiana przez przypadki. It also carries wider meanings of variation, change and transformation. The scene therefore turns mood into a formal process of transformation, but the process cannot complete its final relational movement.
- The echo makes calling an acoustic event: bigger than the speaker, still unmet.
- It is not a repair, but a precise description of non-repair. The room acknowledges the missing form without being able to bridge the gap.

Counting lens

The manufactured middle

- The scene number is a manufactured seven: $6+1$, also readable as $8-1$. Seven must be made either by addition or subtraction rather than appearing cleanly.
- The scene number contains exactly 7 characters or 8 with the prime market, 12 or 13 together with the word “scene”.
- WOŁACZ = 6, embodied Polish calling; VOCATIVE = 8, the academic label. Address becomes terminology.
- This is the first time 6 and 8 appear together in one title since PROLOGUE = FINALE, which presents the same numbers in reverse order. If the Prologue can be read as 8 returning or turning towards 6 – the adult performer, trapped in masking, moving in a way Maksio wanted to move – then this scene is about 6 turning into 8, about Maksio becoming Masking M.
- With the Prologue included, this is Scene 8. Without the Prologue, it is Scene 7: the midpoint of a sixteen-scene structure is itself numerically unstable.
- The title fails to contain the grammatical material inside it. WOŁACZ offers 6 letters and VOCATIVE offers 8, but neither contains the seven cases cleanly.

Silence, syllables and the missing final form

- The scene opens with 14 seconds of silence. Fourteen is 2×7 , but also $6+8$: WOŁACZ + VOCATIVE, MAKSIO + MASKING M, and the fourteen forms conventionally available to a Polish noun across seven singular and seven plural cases.
- The complete seven-case singular paradigm of *chandra* would contain 14 syllables, mirroring those opening 14 seconds.
- Only 12 syllables are spoken. The missing two are the two syllables of *chandro*, the vocative form whose absence prevents the spoken paradigm from reaching 14.

The unstable base unit

- *Chandra* has 7 written letters, but Maksio counts it as 6 on his fingers.
- Polish has seven cases, with the last one often described as “dying out”: either seven, or six plus one. Maksio passes through six cases and cannot complete the seventh.

- The count is wrong from the start. He reaches the seventh case having been one short all along.
- The scene's failure also depends on a second hidden count-problem. For the word to fit, **ch** must be recognised as one sound represented by two written characters.
- The missing seven is therefore not produced by subtraction alone. To reach it, Maksio must be willing – or conditioned – to count that apparently single sound as two written components, even though one of them contributes no separately audible unit.
- The difficulty lies in accepting a rule under which one functioning unit must be processed as two components.
- In miniature, the spelling problem already contains the play's wider two-body logic: one functioning identity distributed across two bodies.
- The counting on fingers is a structural callback to Scene 5. There, mrówka = six letters = six legs holds cleanly and gives Maksio joy. Here, he tries to produce the same equilibrium between chandra and the seven-case system, but the base unit is unstable, so the fit collapses.
- Chandra oscillates between seven and eight written letters across its case endings: a bridge between 6 and 8 in which 7 cannot appear cleanly.

From one unit to two

- *Wolacz* is the final single-word title before the five-scene sequence of internally doubled titles begins.
- The transition extends the scene's digraph problem into the architecture of the play. In **ch**, two visible characters form one functioning sound. In Scenes 8–12, two visible words form one functioning title.
- In Act 1, the second element usually appears as a translation or classificatory overlay placed beside the title. After *Wolacz*, doubleness is no longer external explanation; it becomes part of the title's own construction.
- The scene therefore marks a change in the play's basic unit. The question of whether two written components can function as one sound expands into the question of whether two words or two bodies can function as one relational form.

Thirty and the latent second body

- From Mianownik through the unfinished *Wolacz*, the case recitation contains 30 words:

$$4 + 4 + 4 + 4 + 6 + 7 + 1 = 30$$

- Thirty is also 5×6 , matching the letter counts of BLACK $\times$ FIGURE.
- The second body has not yet entered the play, but the scene can be read as producing its arithmetic before its physical form appears.

Thirty-three and the three reflected appearances

- If the paradigm were completed according to the customary school formula, it would contain 33 words.
- $33 = 3 \times 11$, while BLACK FIGURE contains 11 letters.
- The completed grammatical structure therefore produces three Still Figure counts. These foreshadow the three later appearances in which the figure enters a scene reflecting an earlier Maksio scene:
 - Scene 9 reflects Scene 5
 - Scene 11 reflects Scene 3
 - Scene 13 reflects Scene 1
- Across those three encounters, the Still Figure moves from behind Masking M, to beside him, to facing him in synchronised contact. Witnessing gradually becomes relation, and relation begins to make direct address possible.
- The Still Figure does not complete the missing vocative linguistically. Instead, the three reflected appearances begin to complete its dramatic function: the call that failed within grammar gradually finds another body capable of receiving and answering it.
- Completion is therefore deferred and translated. What cannot be finished as a school recitation returns later as presence, mirroring, harmony and touch.
- Scene 10 is the additional Still Figure appearance outside that reflection system.
- The Still Figure's pre-waltz structure is therefore $3+1$: three encounters across the axis of Scene $6+1=8-1$ that transform failed calling into relation, and one anomalous intervention inside the Masking M world.

Forty-four and incompatible completion

- The six noun forms actually spoken before the missing vocative contain 44 letters.

- $44 = 4 \times 11$, while BLACK FIGURE contains 11 letters. Read retrospectively, the incomplete paradigm arithmetically foreshadows all four Still Figure appearances before the final waltz.
- Four letters also function as the glossary's compact system-register. The 4-letter column is dominated by words such as STEP, FOOT, DESK, BELL and BODY: small units through which movement, placement, timing and bodily conduct are organised.
- Forty-four can therefore be read as BLACK FIGURE passed through that four-letter apparatus: FOOT becomes STEP; BODY is placed at DESK; BELL calls the system into action.
- But FOOT and STEP also become the heavy footsteps that drive the Still Figure away in Scenes 9 and 11. The same four-letter apparatus that arithmetically produces the figure also generates the sound that expels them. Forty-four therefore holds both presence and exclusion: the second body can appear within the system's counted language, but cannot remain safely inside the world that language constructs.
- A fully completed seven-case paradigm based consistently on Maksio's six-letter handra would also contain 44 letters.
- Forty-four can therefore be reached in two incompatible ways:
 - the correctly spelt paradigm reaches 44 only by stopping before the vocative
 - the incorrectly spelt paradigm reaches 44 only by completing all seven cases
- The arithmetic permits either correctness without completion or completion without correctness, but not both at once. The form can be correct, or it can arrive, but it cannot do both. The Still Figure carries the same contradiction: arithmetically produced by the system, physically driven out by it.

Sixty and Scene 10

- The seven Polish case names contain 60 letters.
- $60 = 6 \times 10$, or MAKSIO multiplied by Scene 10.
- Maksio is not visibly present as Maksio in Scene 10, but the Still Figure is. The equation creates a quiet tension around where the six-letter self has gone: absent from the scene, carried into it by the second body, or returning in a form the system does not recognise as Maksio.
- It does not resolve the Still Figure's identity, but allows the figure to carry an arithmetic trace of him.

- Ten may also operate as a framework of complementary scene numbers across the earlier part of the play. The Scene Map does not need to prescribe the meanings of those juxtapositions; the reader can perform their own emotional arithmetic.

181, the missing “with”, and divisibility

- The case recitation from Mianownik through the unfinished Wołacz contains exactly 181 letters as written.
- 181 is prime. The language generated by the seven-case system becomes indivisible at the precise point where the grammatical and relational sequence fails to complete.
- Primehood therefore does not arrive through successful completion. It appears inside an unfinished act of calling: the sequence breaks, but the verbal structure it has produced cannot be divided evenly.
- Restoring the customary z before chandrą would bring the count to 182.
- $182 = 2 \times 7 \times 13$.
- The added letter means “with”. Adding “with” turns an indivisible prime structure into a composite one. Among its factors are 7, the scene’s missing-middle number, and 13, the later Mantra contact island where relation with the Still Figure becomes sustainable.
- This complicates the play’s prime logic. Indivisibility may suggest integrity, but it may also suggest isolation. Divisibility may suggest classification and fragmentation, but here it is produced by adding “with”: composite structure becomes relational structure.

A seven-letter vocabulary around the failure

- Several words describing the scene are themselves seven letters long:

CALLING / FAILURE / SILENCE / ODMIANA

- *Odmiana* names the grammatical operation, but also change or transformation.
- The scene’s missing seven is therefore surrounded by seven-letter states: calling that cannot complete, silence that answers it, failure as dramatic action, and declension as attempted transformation through form.

Three system recitations and one failed recitation

- Scenes 2, 4 and 6 form a sequence of three Masking M recital scenes governed by eight-letter titles: CROWDING, TAXONOMY and EMOTIONS. Each tries to organise unstable living material through memorisation, classification or definition.
- Wołacz adds a fourth recital, but transfers the form back to Maksio. He turns feeling into a grammatical paradigm, and the system fails at the point of direct address.
- This creates a 3+1 structure: three Masking M recitations carried out inside the 8-world, followed by one Maksio recitation suspended between the six-letter WOŁACZ, the eight-letter VOCATIVE and the seven cases neither title can contain cleanly.

Midpoint, 8+8 and the red pen

- With the Prologue counted as the first event, Wołacz is the eighth scene in a sixteen-part performance structure. It therefore sits at an 8+8 midpoint.
- That 8+8 division echoes NATIONAL TREASURE and CZERWONY DŁUGOPIS, both of which contain two eight-letter words.
- DŁUGOPIS literally means “long-writer”, linking the red pen to extended writing, repetition and the infinity logic of 8.
- TREASURE becomes active rather than merely lexical when Maksio rolls the red pen towards the audience. The object associated with correction and national value is placed within the spectators’ reach, allowing them to imagine what they might mark, revise or erase, including what made them uncomfortable or what they did not enjoy.

SCENE 8 – CLIMBING & SLIPPING

On the surface

- Masking M recites π in rhythmic chunks, apologises flatly, then shifts into Fibonacci.
- Fibonacci keeps restarting and accelerating before becoming stuck at 88 and fracturing into “eight, eight, eight...”.
- Without any outside cue, he reaches for the book and rips out one page.
- As he begins scrunching it, a brief electronic ding sounds. A female voice from backstage says:

“Excellent M!”

- There is a slight separation between the two words, but not a full pause.
- He does not react. He continues scrunching the page, then rips out three more pages, closes the book and is taken into blackout.

Deeper reading

- Two 7s are replaced by 8s in π . This may initially read like a mistake to anyone mouthing along, until it happens again.
- Endless counting becomes rhythmic trance: aspiration as compulsion.
- Fibonacci rises in theory, but here it slips and jams at 88. Progress is replaced by loop.
- The sequence finally becomes trapped on 888. This may recall the attempt to rise becoming stuck at the eight-metre height where cumulus clouds supposedly hang in Scene 4, obscuring everything.
- Masking M continues rising physically with the sequence, foreshadowing the climb in Sisyphus Trap.
- The first page-rip happens without footsteps, instruction or an external threat. The conditioning has become self-starting: Masking M performs the required act before the system asks for it.
- The feedback arrives only after the destruction has begun. It does not cause the first rip, but validates it and immediately precedes the removal of three further pages. Praise has shifted from rewarding compliance after the fact to accelerating behaviour that has become self-sustaining.
- The electronic ding and backstage source mark another stage in the feedback’s development. What began as socially plausible praise from the edge of the audience now resembles an interface response: brief, efficient and generated by the machinery behind the performance.
- The slight separation in “Excellent M!” leaves the grammar unstable. It may be heard as direct address – “Excellent, M!” – but also as classification: “Excellent M”, an excellent version, model or specimen of M.
- This ambiguity continues the logic of the earlier taxonomy and emotions scenes. Masking M is not only being told that he has performed an action well. He is being assessed as a type of M that has successfully fulfilled its function.

- By the end of the scene, the total number of page-rips across the play has reached seven. Seven exists materially as damage and absence.
- The transition into Scene 9 is especially cruel. Scene 8 ends by declaring him excellent; Scene 9 reveals the same body flat on the floor and unable to respond. Burnout follows not because the system has judged him a failure, but because he has fulfilled its demand.

Counting lens

Eight, ascent and the interrupted sequence

- CLIMBING = 8 and SLIPPING = 8: a double-8 stamp of looped labour and infinite effort.
- The title also points towards SISYPHUS, an eight-letter word, within Scene 8.
- Fibonacci should continue from 88 to 89, which is prime, but Masking M becomes stuck at 88. Aspiration is diverted away from indivisibility and back into the loop of 8.
- The 9 he cannot reach numerically appears instead in the language of evaluation: EXCELLENT contains 9 letters. Masking M supplies the repeated 8s; the system supplies the missing 9 from outside.
- The scene ends on 888, and a pattern becomes increasingly visible. Eight has appeared not only in the Masking M scene titles but in conspicuously “wrong” places within their spoken material:
 - Scene 2, Crowding, is dominated by 8, while 7 leaks through in the Lublin correction.
 - Scene 4, Taxonomy, places the sixth and only seven-letter cloud type at exactly 8 metres.
 - Scene 6, Emotions, declares that shame has 8 meanings.
 - Scene 8 traps the rising Fibonacci sequence on 88 and then fractures it into repeated eights.

The piano as a system of acceptable units

- Eighty-eight is also the number of keys on a standard piano, extending across seven octaves plus a minor third at the very bottom of the keyboard.
- As a standardised instrument of performance, the piano spans more than 4,000 Hz but permits only 88 named notes within that range. A continuous field of sound is divided into acceptable units, while everything between them remains outside the system.

Fibonacci positions and later scenes

- The number 8 occupies position 6 in the Fibonacci sequence, continuing the tense relationship between 6 and 8 established in the preceding scene.
- Position 7 is 13, anticipating Scene 13, Mantra.
- Position 8 is 21, a number that becomes structurally important later in the piece.

The third feedback message

- EXCELLENT contains 9 letters; EXCELLENT M contains 10.
- “Excellent” contains 8 sound-units, while the spoken “em” brings the total to 10.
- The three feedback messages now form a written progression:

GOOD JOB = 7 → GOOD JOB M = 8

WELL DONE = 8 → WELL DONE M = 9

EXCELLENT = 9 → EXCELLENT M = 10

- Their sound-unit progression is:

6→8 / 6→8 / 8→10

- Across sounds, letters and the addition of M, the sequence produces every number from 6 to 10. It resembles an orderly ascending ladder only because the unit of measurement keeps changing. Sounds become letters, and the addressed initial becomes part of the count. The rules shift underneath Masking M while still presenting the result as progress.

Twenty-four letters and divisibility

- GOOD JOB, WELL DONE and EXCELLENT contain 24 letters in total.
- Twenty-four can be reached as both 6×4 and 8×3 .
- Four is the largest proper divisor of 8, while three is the largest proper divisor of 6. The two central numbers meet by being multiplied by the largest part into which the other can be evenly divided.
- Neither the six-letter MAKSIÖ count nor the eight-letter MASKING M count is prime. Both are composite, capable of being divided, classified and rearranged into the same measurable total.
- Twenty-four itself has eight positive divisors, reinforcing its position as a highly divisible system-number.

- This does not mark the first invasion of a previously protected six-letter world. Maksio's scenes have been classified from the beginning through the seven-letter Latin overlays ADNUBES, AMISSUM and FORMICA. The dead language of taxonomy, diagnosis, criteria and observable behaviour has already been placed over the child-world. The feedback sequence formalises a pressure that has been active throughout the play.

SCENE 9 – BELL ANOMALY

On the surface

- Lights snap on: Masking M lies flat on the floor. Silence.
- Bells loop with blackouts. The expected reset does not happen; Masking M remains on the floor.
- The pattern glitches, and the seventh bell stutters.
- The same bell continues ringing, each strike becoming more strained. As the rings begin to overlap, three processed voices cut through from backstage in sequence:
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 1:** "Good job!"
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 2:** "Well done!"
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 3:** "Excellent!"
- Before the system can settle, the same three-part sequence fires again, in the same voices and the same order:
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 1:** "Good job!"
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 2:** "Well done!"
 - **FEEDBACK VOICE 3:** "Excellent!"
- The second pass is tighter and more compressed. The phrases begin to crowd the bell and one another. No "M" is heard.
- The bell collapses into a continuous grinding ring, breaks, and leaves silence.
- A distant child-cry is heard.
- The Still Figure enters silently and sits behind Masking M. Later, the heavy footsteps return; blackout.

Deeper reading

- The typo is dramaturgy: the system's error message leaks into the world.
- The scene subverts the pattern established earlier. By the third bell, the audience expects the desk reset, but the body remains on the floor.
- The seventh bell failing renders the missing seven in sound.
- Scene 8 ends with "Excellent M!" attached to active self-erasure. Scene 9 begins by revealing the praised body completely still. Excellence becomes aftermath: this is what successful performance has cost.
- The feedback phrases return after losing their original human contexts. "Good job, M!" first came from near the front of the auditorium; "Well done, M!" came from further back on the opposite side; "Excellent M!" arrived with an electronic ding from backstage. Here, the phrases are stripped down, redistributed between different processed voices and replayed as parts of the malfunctioning machinery.
- The praise continues even though Masking M does not move and the bell can no longer perform its own function reliably. Reward and command have lost synchronisation, but both mechanisms continue operating. The system can no longer accurately cue, observe or respond; it can only repeat its learned outputs.
- Repeating the full sequence makes the praise behave like a loop that cannot stop itself. The first pass remains legible as three separate messages; the second begins to compress them into an automatic routine.
- The removal of "M" takes away the final trace of personal address. Earlier, the system at least appeared to praise someone. Here, the vocabulary of approval survives without a recipient.
- The missing M can be read as another stage of erasure. The book has lost pages, the body has lost its capacity to respond, and the feedback has lost the person it was supposedly addressing. Only the reward language remains.
- This retrospectively sharpens the ambiguity of "Excellent M!" in Scene 8. That phrase hovered between direct praise – "Excellent, M!" – and classification – "Excellent M". Scene 9 resolves the ambiguity brutally: the system keeps "Excellent" and discards M.

- The Still Figure's position behind Masking M reads as gentle witnessing or co-regulation. Their presence answers Scene 5's question about whether anyone comes back for a lost ant, but the return of the heavy footsteps breaks the possibility of sustained contact.

Counting lens

- ANOMAALY is misspelt deliberately to make it an eight-letter word. The glitch aligns with the loop and infinity logic of 8: not a one-off incident, but a repeatable mechanism. Developing a mask is not treated as an anomaly by the system; it is expected.
- BELL ANOMAALY contains 12 letters. By this scene, there have also been 12 functioning bells: 3×4.
- Scene 9 is the only odd-numbered scene not absorbed into the prime-marked contact-island system. Scene 1 is also mathematically non-prime, but is deliberately marked and later given a relational justification.
- BELL BELL BELL also contains 12 letters in total.
- The title's 4+8 structure inverts the 8+4 of ŻELAZOWA WOLA. Iron will and iron freedom remain present as a tension within the scene's logic.
- GOOD JOB, WELL DONE and EXCELLENT contain 24 letters in one complete pass.
- The sequence is heard twice, producing:
 $24 \times 2 = 48$
- Forty-eight is also:
 6×8 - the two numbers held in tension by the title are multiplied directly into one highly divisible total.
- The doubled sequence gives the recurring 47/48 thread another major turn:
 - the Prologue establishes $12+12+12+11 = 47$ breath-notes, one short of the expected 48
 - Scene 2 repeatedly presents 48 inside the city populations before Lublin is corrected from 448 to 447
 - Scene 4 compresses 6–7–8 into the sixth cloud type, its seven-letter name and its exact eight-metre height
 - Scene 9 produces 48 directly through the repeated feedback loop

- In Scene 2, movement from 48 to the prime 47 transforms a divisible system-value into indivisibility. In Scene 9, the malfunctioning reward system reconstructs 48 through repetition, processing the earlier prime rupture back into a composite and repeatable pattern.
- If Scene $6+1=8-1$ is read as the axis of symmetry, Scene 9 mirrors Scene 5, Mrówka.
- Scene 5 asks whether anyone will return for a lost ant. Scene 9 is the first time Masking M fails to comply with the bells, and the Still Figure arrives after the violent bell glitches. The arithmetic mirror therefore becomes relational: the missing or abandoned small being is finally answered by another body entering the space.

SCENE 10 – INFINITE SYMPHONY

On the surface

- Masking M at the desk, five medals, almost perfectly still.
- Dense overload soundstorm fills the room.
- The Still Figure enters silently and touches him; the sound implodes into one metallic scream; blackout lands precisely on its end.

Deeper reading

- Overload staged as cognitive impossibility: the audience brain keeps trying to prioritise and can't.
- Constant core elements (pre-selected, fixed set): typing; indicator click; car doors; explosive mocking laughter; orgasmic male moans; church organ tones; sports hall echo + bouncing balls; busy market crowd; low engine drone/traffic; meat slap/chop; warped "Cicha Noc" (festive/sickly); one embedded "Oi, you!"; water splashes + surfacing-for-air gasps.
- Additional layers sit on top (as documented in the Sound Summary).
- Freeze becomes socially invisible: stimulus is immense; movement is microscopic; the audience may doubt what they saw.
- Touch doesn't soothe – it collapses the world into a single non-human scream (hard reset, not comfort).

Counting lens

- INFINITE = 8 and SYMPHONY = 8: a perfect 8/8 balance turned cruel, with “music” becoming too-muchness.
- If Wołacz – Scene 7, manufactured as $6+1=8-1$ – is read as the axis of symmetry, Scene 10 mirrors Scene 4, Taxonomy.
- The Still Figure appears here even though Scene 10 does not reflect a Maksio scene from Act 1. Their entrance therefore initially reads as an anomaly within the established reflection pattern.
- In Scene 7, the seven Polish case names contain 60 letters. $60 = 6 \times 10$, or MAKSIÖ multiplied by Scene 10.
- Maksio is not visibly present as Maksio in Scene 10, but the Still Figure is. The arithmetic creates a quiet tension around where the six-letter self has gone: absent from the scene, carried into it by the second body, or returning in a form the system does not recognise as Maksio. The equation does not resolve the Still Figure’s identity, but allows the figure to carry an arithmetic trace of him.
- The connection to Scene 4 sits in the shift from classification to pressure. In Taxonomy, naming and ordering still function: clouds are sorted by type and altitude, and the body remains locked inside recital and control.
- Scene 10 returns to the same system-world under maximum strain. A high-density soundscape accumulates while Masking M sits frozen at the desk. Upon touch, the layered sound tightens into a single scream and the body briefly loosens: a short release inside the system posture.

SCENE 1.1 (prime) – BURNOUT & HARMONY

On the surface

- Masking M lies inert; long silence.
- Child-cries return; the Still Figure enters and sits behind him, then lies beside him (parallel, non-touch).
- The cries settle into a minor third; a faint waltz pulse appears within them.

- Footsteps return; harmony collapses; the Still Figure flees; blackout.

Deeper reading

- Positioning is the dramaturgy: behind = witness/co-regulator; beside = shared grounding, still without touch.
- Harmony is structural, not sentimental. It arrives only under safety and is broken by approach.
- The moving minor thirds turn harmony into an active negotiation rather than a settled resolution. Whenever one cry approaches the pitch of the other, the other shifts away and re-establishes the interval. The voices repeatedly approach unison without remaining there.
- This movement does not necessarily signify rejection. Neither voice abandons the other; they keep rebuilding relation through difference. They can remain together without becoming identical or requiring one voice to absorb the other.
- Because the exchange travels upwards and downwards, neither voice remains permanently higher, lower or dominant. The harmony creates a mobile equilibrium in which each voice responds to the movement of the other.
- Both bodies remain still while the voices continue moving. In burnout, physical action has almost disappeared, but relation can still travel through sound.
- “Maksio presence” returns via mirroring rather than language.
- The approaching footsteps destroy not a static image of comfort, but a fragile relational system that has been continually adjusting in order to remain connected.

Counting lens

Eleven, mirrored ones and relational primehood

- The prime marking of Scene 11 makes it a key reconnection node.
- BLACK FIGURE contains 11 letters, and this is the first time in the piece that the Still Figure mirrors the protagonist exactly. The two bodies can be read as the two 1s of 11: one figure and its reflected counterpart becoming a new number through harmony and mirroring.
- The scene-list typography makes this relationship visible as 1·1, with one 1 reflected rather than simply repeated.

- This can retrospectively clarify the otherwise mathematically incorrect black prime dot beside Scene 1. One is not prime, but the play's cosmology provisionally treats it as prime because it is one half of the later mirrored 1·1 structure.
- The red pen gently strikes through that dot, acknowledging the mathematical error without fully cancelling its dramaturgical truth. Scene 1 is not prime in isolation, but it already carries the mark of the contact and mirroring that will later make the two ones into 11.
- Primehood here therefore becomes relational rather than purely mathematical: the single 1 is marked according to what it may become when its mirror appears.
- The author's legal name, MAKSYMILIAN, also contains 11 letters. The legal self therefore shares the number created when the two bodies mirror one another.

Scene 1 retrospectively reassigned

- Scene 11 retrospectively reassigns meaning to the apparently unattached black dot beside Scene 1. In *Chmury*, Maksio spends the entire scene reaching outward: calling "Mamo", touching the book, tearing and tasting a cloud, wanting to return inside fog, believing that the weather responds to him, warning Mamo about the approaching storm, and physically reworking an idiom into his own meaning.
- These are all forms of connection: with another person, an object, the environment and language itself. This open, self-initiated contact disappears from the Masking M scenes, where relation is replaced by instruction, measurement, surveillance and reward.
- His slip *mniebo* briefly fuses *mnie* – "me" – with *niebo* – "sky". The solitary 1 and its dot seem momentarily joined to the world around them, but no second body has yet appeared to answer or mirror him.
- When Scene 11 later presents **1·1**, the Scene 1 dot can be reread as a premature relational mark: not merely an incorrect sign of primehood, but the suspended point at which the first 1 is already reaching towards its reflected counterpart.
- Scene 1's language also contains the counting rule that later traps Maksio in *Wołacz*. After hearing the conventional phrase *urwanie chmury*, he processes it into *rwanie chmury* – "the ripping of a cloud" – turning received language into his own literal action.

- RWANIE CHMURY contains **6+6 written letters but 5+5 sound-units**, because **ni** and **ch** each function as one sound. STRASZNE BURZYSKO contains **8+8 written letters but 7+7 sound-units**, because **sz** and **rz** perform the same compression.
- In Scene 1, two written components becoming one sound produces delight, symmetry and play. In Scene 6+1=8-1, the same rule becomes coercive: Maksio must accept that one audible unit is represented by two separately countable characters for the written count to reach seven.
- What becomes an explicit grammatical crisis in *Wolacz* is therefore already embedded in Scene 1's language of wonder, weather and play.
- Scene 11 finally makes that structure bodily visible. Each performer can be read as one of the two 1s, while the human form may also resemble a 7 from another angle. Depending on position and viewpoint, the bodies can therefore suggest **1 and 1, 7 and 7, or the joined 11**.
- The two-body logic does not imply that either body is inactive or redundant. One functioning identity is carried by two distinct, active bodies, and their relation becomes legible precisely because both remain visible. The spelling structure first encountered playfully in Scene 1 and made painful in *Wolacz* becomes embodied through mirroring in Scene 11.

Prime combinations and divided selves

- BLACK FIGURE + MAKSIO = 17, which is prime.
- BLACK FIGURE + MASKING M = 19, also prime.
- Through the Still Figure, Masking M can therefore enter a prime-marked contact island.
- By contrast, MAKSIO + MASKING M = 14, or 2×7: the two named versions of the self remain divisible when placed together without the Still Figure.
- The digit 1 traced by either performer's body could also resemble a 7 from another angle. Masking M and the Still Figure may therefore be read as 1, 7 and 11 simultaneously, depending on viewpoint.
- The scene does not force one correct numerical identity onto either body. As their physical relation changes, the same image can generate different numbers.

Seven, fourteen and off-by-one structures

- BURNOUT = 7 and HARMONY = 7. The title creates a double seven in which 7 holds both wound and brief repair.
- The title contains 14 letters, foreshadowing Scene 14, where the attempt at fuller integration takes place.
- Fourteen also recalls MAKŚIO + MASKING M and WOŁACZ + VOCATIVE: two opposing six- and eight-letter terms held together as 6+8.
- Seven-letter words in the handout's vocabulary section complicate the number further. Seven functions not only as erasure or absence, but as a lexicon through which the piece names silence, healing, harmony and loss.
- As the minor-third harmony between the two cries goes up or down twice, they cover a range of notes forming a diminished 7th chord.
- One also recurs as a structural motif. The programme encodes both 1-2-3, through the years of Poland's partitions, and 6-7-8 as sequences built through addition by one.
- In $6+1=8-1$, the space between 6 and 8 consists of two opposing ones. In Scene 11, those two ones are physically present on the floor as the two parallel bodies, reaching harmony.
- Other off-by-one structures echo around them:
 - 88 in the Fibonacci sequence is one below the prime 89
 - π contains two substitutions of 7 by 8, each readable as 7+1
 - MASKING M itself is 7+1 letters
- The opening Fibonacci pair, 1, 1, is also physically evoked by the two bodies lying side by side. What begins mathematically as repetition becomes the starting condition for growth.

Scene 3 reflected: loss becomes presence

- If Scene $6+1=8-1$ is read as the axis of symmetry, Scene 11 mirrors Scene 3, Wiosna.
- The earlier scene turns an unstable loss – season, object, person or state – into frantic searching. Here, the missing becomes a mirrored presence: not recovered through language, but found beside the body through resemblance and harmony.
- The unknown thing Maksio could not find in Scene 3 is not returned as a named object. It reappears as relation: another body occupying the corresponding place.

Minor thirds, three and mobile relation

- The harmony remains organised around a minor third rather than settling into unison. Whenever one cry approaches the other's pitch, the second moves away by a minor third, and the interval is rebuilt above or below.
- The voices therefore repeatedly approach sameness without remaining there. Relation is sustained through responsive difference rather than fusion.
- Because the exchange travels upwards and downwards, neither voice remains permanently higher, lower or dominant. The interval becomes a mobile equilibrium.
- A minor third spans three semitones, while the cries move over a three-beat waltz undertow. Three therefore structures relation both vertically, through pitch, and temporally, through pulse.
- Stacked minor thirds can generate diminished harmony, so the moving interval retains a quiet sense of tonal incompleteness. It belongs to the same world as Scene 3's lost Wiosna: Spring is sensed, approached and relationally reconfigured, but not simply restored.
- The scene's harmony is therefore not a resolved destination. It is a continually rebuilt form of contact that survives only while the two voices remain responsive to one another.

SCENE 12 – SISYPHUS TRAP

On the surface

- Masking M sits atop the too-tall desk like a statue; six medals, the last absurdly large.
- He delivers a long Sisyphus monologue; small stim noted; light subtly dims on "the drop".
- He bows; applause begins; recorded applause swallows it and becomes a techno build that never drops; blackout on him, but applause continues.

Deeper reading

- The piece gives Masking M long-form clarity – and he chooses mechanism: punishment, repetition, the moment after the climb.

- The scene is unusual because it's relatively traditional, it's masking at its best, achieving full legibility, maximum medals.
- The scene is also unusual because it's the only MASKING M scene so far without a slip.
- The “drop” becomes the real tragedy, echoing climb/slip logic.
- Applause becomes a trap: approval turns into coercive machinery; the audience is implicated.
- The Still Figure's absence is structural. At the moment when Masking M achieves maximum legibility, the audience is positioned as the only available relational counterpart. Applause appears to answer the performance, but the answer is evaluative rather than mutual, and is gradually absorbed into recorded machinery. Scene 13 begins from the burnout produced by that false relation and replaces it with a form of contact built through listening, adjustment and shared rhythm.

Counting lens

- Sisyphus = 8; Trap = 4 – infinity labour (8) clamped inside a cage-word (4).
- The word “applause” is 8 letters long, as is Sisyphus. The title of the scene is secretly coded: it's also Applause Trap.
- Inversion echo: answers the 4+8 logic in Bell Anomaaly and the 8+4 (Żelazowa Wola) axis.
- “Sisyphus Trap” = 12 letters (8+4) and it is Scene 12 – 12 signals a major structural hinge in the piece.

SCENE 13• (prime) – MANTRA

On the surface

- Masking M lies collapsed face-down on the floor, his jacket and medals still visible. A faint child's cry is already present beneath the scene, continuing the sound-world of burnout.
- His body moves gradually through stages: face-down stillness, small rolling, sitting cross-legged, then gentle rocking forwards and backwards or from side to side.

- A fragmented mantra emerges slowly, as though he is discovering the shape and texture of each sound in his mouth. It tries to reach “I wrote a book at six”, moving through English, Polish-like sound fragments and German.
- The first four lines repeatedly establish three identical fragments followed by a changed fourth:
 - “I wro” ×3 → “I wrota”
 - “Rota” ×3 → “rotabu”
 - “Tabu” ×3 → “tabook”
 - “Book” ×3 → “Buch”
- Two sudden “BWAH” spikes interrupt the mantra.
- On the first BWAH, a second child’s cry briefly enters at a minor third before falling away.
- On the second BWAH, the minor third remains and stabilises. A waltz pulse begins to emerge inside the held cries, becoming clearer beneath his words.
- As the light widens, it reveals that the Still Figure is already sitting in front of Masking M, facing him and slightly left of centre. They were present before the audience could clearly see them.
- The Still Figure begins by watching. They then rock in the same direction as Masking M before gradually matching his movement more precisely.
- Their positions bring them into standing, facing one another, with their small motions held in synchrony.
- At the moment they both stand, the underlying chord shifts from minor to major. The cries soften or thin, but the harmony brightens.
- They raise their hands in perfect mirror and extend their index fingers towards the space between them.
- When their fingertips meet, an extremely fast upward white-key piano glissando is heard and the light flickers, creating a brief rupture in the image.
- They remain still with their fingers touching as the scene moves into the final waltz.

Deeper reading

- After the applause trap comes a body that can no longer perform. The mantra is residue, self-soothing and an attempt to recover language from its smallest available pieces.

- The opening direction makes speech physical before it becomes semantic. Masking M appears to discover the sounds through their texture in his mouth rather than retrieving a finished sentence.
- The bilingual movement reads as mind-search rather than “gift”. English does not simply give way to German; each new sound is found inside the previous one, as though language is being rebuilt through echo, resemblance and mouth-feel.
- The mantra’s repeated 3+1 structure makes deviation generative. Three identical fragments establish temporary security; the fourth changes, but does not destroy the pattern.
- Each altered fourth term becomes the material from which the next line grows:
 - *wrota* releases *rota*
 - *rotabu* releases *tabu*
 - *tabook* releases *book*
 - *Buch* is carried into *Ein Buch*
- The “wrong” or anomalous fourth unit therefore becomes a bridge rather than an error. Difference is what allows the language to continue.
- The two BWAHs stage relation as something learned in two attempts. The first briefly produces a second voice and then loses it. The second allows the interval to remain, stabilise and carry the emerging waltz pulse.
- The Still Figure is not staged as arriving to rescue Masking M. They are already present before the light makes them legible. The scene turns their apparent entrance into recognition: another body has been there, waiting within the darkness of the image.
- Their movement develops incrementally from observation, to directional sympathy, to matching rhythm, to full synchrony. Co-regulation is choreographed as a process rather than an instantaneous cure.
- Shared rhythm makes standing possible. Neither body pulls the other upright; a relational pattern gradually creates the conditions in which both can rise.
- If the minor third in Scene 11 echoes the keyboard’s built-in remainder, then the move to a major third in Scene 13 matters precisely because it is no longer that remainder. The harmony does not leave the system altogether, but it stops sounding like what the system leaves behind.

- This also resists the usual shorthand of minor as sad and major as happy. The change matters less as mood-colour than as a change in relation: from inhabiting the system's leftover interval to sounding differently within it.
- The shift to major occurs when the bodies stand together. The harmonic change is therefore attached not to emotional triumph but to an altered physical and relational arrangement.
- The fingertip meeting gives contact its smallest possible form. After earlier scenes in which touch overwhelms, resets or remains impossible, connection is reduced to one precise shared point.
- The upward white-key glissando briefly reintroduces the standardised piano system, but as a rapid surge rather than a stable scale or recital. The flicker prevents the image from settling into uncomplicated resolution.
- The contact does not conclude the action. The two bodies remain joined as the final waltz begins, so touch becomes a bridge into sustained shared form rather than a climactic endpoint.

Counting lens

- The prime marking of Scene 13 makes this the final contact island: patient presence rather than sudden breakthrough.
- MANTRA = 6, marking a late return to the six-letter world.
- MANTRA appears to restore the single-word title after five doubled titles, but it does not restore the earlier single-unit world. Language is breaking back into repetition, mouth-feel and sound, while the title's unwritten second component is physically present as the Still Figure. The verbal title contracts to one six-letter word at precisely the moment when the stage image becomes fully two-bodied.
- The scene reasserts the energy of "I wrote a book at 6" without returning to solitary six-world identity: the six-letter word is now carried inside a two-body relation.
- $13 = 6+7$: Maksio together with the missing or erased middle, held within a single prime number. This can be read as wound, contact or partial repair depending on where the emphasis falls.
- The first four mantra lines each enact $3+1$: three repeated units followed by one altered fourth.

- The structure occurs four times, but the fourth unit is never merely an exception. It supplies the root of the following line, so the +1 repeatedly becomes the seed of the next pattern.
- The mantra therefore offers a reparative version of 3+1. Elsewhere, the additional one may appear as anomaly, interruption or the element outside a mirror system. Here, the anomalous unit is what permits continuity.
- This quietly rhymes with the Still Figure's pre-waltz appearance structure: three appearances within the Maksio reflection pattern and one additional appearance in Scene 10 outside it. By Scene 13, the apparently anomalous "+1" can be reread as a necessary bridge rather than an error.
- The first BWAH briefly creates the second voice; the second stabilises it. The scene therefore moves from one cry to two through repetition rather than immediate completion.
- If Scene $6+1=8-1$ is read as the axis of symmetry, Scene 13 mirrors Scene 1, Chmury. Masking M remembers the book not as a complete autobiographical statement but as sound, rhythm and bodily sensation.
- Scene 1 is organised around upward attention, reaching and clouds descending towards Maksio. In Scene 13, Masking M and the Still Figure stand together for the first time, preparing the final upward movement of the piece.
- The Latin title Ad Nubes means "to the clouds". The direction introduced in the first Maksio scene returns here as shared vertical movement rather than solitary reaching.

SCENE 14 – 6–7–8

On the surface

- Final dance: silence → low beat → Ravel's La Valse.
- Time dilates/accelerates; seven-ish phrases are felt before settling into fuller eight-cycles.
- Lighting widens; areas they leave remain faintly lit (the stage keeps traces).
- The Still Figure supports a climb: Masking M stands on the desk, then onto the Still Figure's shoulders.

- Tight central limelight; he shouts: “Mamo, look at me!” – instant blackout.

Deeper reading

- The final waltz can redistribute “leadership” itself: who moves forward may switch every 7 bars at first, then every 8, so that relational structure – not only rhythm – passes from instability into shared form.
- La Valse is a piece that occasionally spirals into madness and chaos, just like the split between warm Maksio scenes and harsh Masking M scenes.
- Integration attempt (not resolution): rhythm is negotiated by bodies before music imposes it.
- The Still Figure functions as missing connective tissue between selves – literal support, not metaphor.
- Leaving faint light behind signals memory becoming survivable: the stage stops erasing itself.
- The climax becomes plea: address without guarantee; blackout makes the call hang unanswered.
- The last line is in both Polish and English – both exist in the same space. The scene is about integration.
- The last line is a direct callback to the very first line of the spoken text in Polish (“Mamo, zobacz! Na mniebo!”) where the slip of the tongue effectively produces “Mamo look at me”.
- He finally reaches the height he has been working towards (pointing upwards, looking upwards, heels going up, pushing the stone up) and is supported by the Still Figure – he couldn’t have reached that height without them.

Counting lens

- The private arithmetic becomes the public title: mechanism revealed as form.
- After five titles made from two words and MANTRA’s single word carried by two bodies, Scene 14 abandons ordinary words altogether. The title becomes a numerical sequence: doubleness and relation no longer need to be translated, classified or verbally named because the underlying 6–7–8 structure is finally displayed directly.
- $6+7+8 = 21$ (echoing the 21-minute pre-show and the £6.78 encoding).
- 21 is the reverse of 12 – reversal/mirroring becomes an operation (not just a theme).

- “Mamo” (4) + “look at me” (8) = 12 total – 4+8 logic returns at the climax.
- Scene 14 also contains a callback to Scene 11 whose title is 7+7. In Scene 11, the harmony between Masking M and Still Figure was brief, here it reaches its peak.
- Internal count: this line is also the 21st “Mamo” in the whole piece (hidden structural cue for those counting).
- It's also the 22nd instance of the vocative across the piece (including “Pani mrówko” in the ant scene) - 2x11 or Maksymilian + Still Figure.
- 21st March (author's surname) is the first day of Spring (reference to the Prologue's Prawie Wiosna)
- Maurice Ravel (12) + La Valse (7) is 19 letters long, as is Masking M + Still Figure.
- La Valse is 2+5, the only other such pattern is Ad+Nubes as the Latin overlay of Scene 1, meaning “to the clouds” - the scene ends with MASKING M reaching the highest point in the piece.
- The two-piano version could be interpreted as PIANINO + PIANINO = 7+7 (in the vocabulary).
- If Scene 6+1=8-1 is read as the axis of symmetry, Scene 14 mirrors the Prologue. Was the Still Figure also present there?
- Scene 14 functions as a multi-layered climax because several long-running trajectories peak at once: the upward/height arc (from clouds, pointing up, rising heels, Sisyphus, desk-climbing), the seasonal arc (Marzec / Prawie Wiosna reaching the 21st of March = first day of Spring), the relational arc (Masking M and Still Figure finally sustaining shared form), the musical arc (breath-notes / waltz fragments / pulse resolving into La Valse), the linguistic arc (the final vocative call “Mamo” returning in bilingual form), and the structural counting arc (6–7–8 becoming the public title of the scene, with 21 as its sum).

EPILOGUE = OVERTURE – INFINITE PATIENCE

On the surface

- Pause; three bells.
- Lights snap onto the audience; stage stays shadowed with desk/jacket/book/pen still visible.

- No performer returns. 72 seconds of silence.
- Assistants remove the set neutrally. The red pen drops. Doors open. End.

Deeper reading

- The Epilogue starts in the exact same way as the Prologue - all of the play's props are laid bare. This time, the spectator assigns deeper meanings to them.
- The Epilogue visually takes the spectator back to the Prologue, consolidating a sense of loop.
- When the stage assistants enter and perform the exact same motion as in the Prologue, the furniture removal, which may have been read as a logistical hiccup at the beginning of the piece, is retroactively assigned meaning, potentially making it one of the strongest images of the piece.
- This might also cause some audience members to reassess which “glitches” across the piece, if any, were actually accidental, which consolidates the themes of correction and spectatorship.
- Spotlight transfers to the watchers: the audience inherits exposure.
- No curtain call blocks regulation-by-applause; silence forces staying with uncertainty.
- Red pen drop repeats – correction returns to the floor; nobody resolves it.
- Doors opening is timed as a cue: the piece pushes the audience into action-space, not applause-space.

Counting lens

- EPILOGUE = 8; OVERTURE = 8.
- Infinite (8) Patience (8) – all-eights seal: looped endurance, not closure.
- Infinite Patience = Czerwony Długopis (8+8)
- INFINITE PATIENCE belongs to a three-part family of 8+8 titles:
 - CLIMBING & SLIPPING
 - INFINITE SYMPHONY
 - INFINITE PATIENCE
- Across the three titles, the same doubled structure passes through different bodily states. CLIMBING & SLIPPING stages active effort repeatedly turning into instability. INFINITE

SYMPHONY stages overwhelming density inside an almost motionless body. INFINITE PATIENCE removes the performer altogether, but leaves the audience inside prolonged duration.

- INFINITE SYMPHONY makes the connection most explicit by repeating the word INFINITE. CLIMBING & SLIPPING reveals that the 8+8 machinery began earlier, in aspiration, repetition and collapse.
- The Epilogue's silence is therefore not outside the double-eight system. It is its exhausted continuation: the visible labour has stopped, but the duration remains.
- 72 as "textbook" heartbeat; waltz often described as heartbeat.
- $72 = 6 \times 12$ – multiplication of key numbers - by Scene 12, where applause is used as a device of approval, Masking M has accumulated 6 medals given by "authority". One Sisyphus climb for each medal.
- 72 has exactly 12 divisors.
- 72 also sits between the twin primes 71 and 73 – a highly divisible number squeezed between two indivisible ones.
- 72 is the 8th such integer.
- This also makes a reference to 42 - the 6th integer "squeezed" between two primes and, importantly, the number of words in the "vocabulary of particularly important terminology".
- 73 is explicitly mentioned in the bio as the distance between Lublin and the Ukrainian border. 73 here serves as a "border" that 72 almost reaches.

WOŁACZ CORNER (POST-SHOW)

On the surface

- A "WOŁACZ" ballot-style box.
- Cards: "What I'd like to say to ... is ..."
- Two pens offered: black and red.

Deeper reading

- Alternative to applause: post-show energy rerouted into structured, quieter address.

- Red pen becomes consent-based: earlier, red = imposed correction; here, you choose black/red (write vs correct, bless vs revise).
- Ballot framing politicises address: private aftermath becomes civic gesture.
- “Wołacz” returns as the exit mechanism: the show ends by offering a practice of calling after staging a long history of calling failing.

“JUST SOMETHING I NOTICED” (POSSIBLE DIGITAL AFTERLIFE)

On the surface

A moderated website space where audiences can share counts, echoes, patterns, structural hunches and partial discoveries after seeing the work.

Deeper reading

Not a publication of the Scene Map, but a continuation of its logic in public form. The collaborator document remains internal; what becomes collective is the act of mapping. Different spectators notice different things, and meaning accumulates through shared acts of attention rather than through one authorised explanation.

Counting lens

The phrase “Just something I noticed” already appears in the handout as a low-stakes invitation into pattern-literacy. In a digital afterlife, it becomes a distributed noticing practice: an audience-built equivalent of the Scene Map, created partially, socially and over time.

GLOBAL COUNTING NOTE

the 7-letter Latin overlays (Scenes 1 / 3 / 5)

- AdNubes / Amissum / Formica are all 7 letters.

- In this cosmology, 7 first appears as erasure and the missing middle, but later expands to hold silence, healing, harmony and relation.
- Dramaturgically: categorising/codifying the lived experience is an act of reduction – a quiet parallel to neurodivergence assessment language.